Newsroom

COMPLETE DOCUMENTATION SET

Newsroom User Handbook

Installation, daily operation, editorial practice, maintenance and recovery

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Newsroom 1.0.0 for Windows
Documentation version 1.0
Verified 31 October 2026

NEWSROOM · COMPLETE DOCUMENTATION SET

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Six manuals, one volume

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Each document also has its own contents page in the standalone PDF. Bookmarks in this PDF mirror every heading.

NEWSROOM · DOCUMENT 00

Documentation Index

Navigation, verified scope and document map

Product: Newsroom 1.0.0 for Windows
Build verified: packaged `Newsroom.exe` and `NewsroomSetup.exe` of 31 October 2026
Documentation version: 1.0, 31 October 2026
Publisher: Newsroom documentation set

This is the navigation hub for the Newsroom user documentation. The manuals describe the installed Windows product, not its source-code development. Where a behaviour could not be verified, it is marked as unverified in the manual and recorded in the internal verification notes.

1. Which manual do I need?

If you want to…	Read
Install Newsroom and produce a first edition	**Quick Start**
Look up a screen, field or button	**User Manual**
Decide what to publish, review evidence or release an issue	**Editorial & Publishing Guide**
Back up, update, restore or uninstall	**Installation & Maintenance**
Fix a problem	**Troubleshooting & FAQ**

Reader paths

- **New installation:** Quick Start → Installation & Maintenance when needed → User Manual.
- **Daily issue production:** Editorial & Publishing Guide → User Manual for controls.
- **Something broke:** Troubleshooting & FAQ → Installation & Maintenance for safe recovery.

2. The document set

Document	What it covers	Markdown	PDF
Documentation Index	This map, versions and scope	00-DOCUMENTATION-INDEX.md	**PDF**
Quick Start	Install, first run, AI readiness, source, branding, first build, preview, release and e-paper	01-QUICK-START.md	**PDF**
User Manual	Every verified screen and control, from Dashboard to Audit	02-USER-MANUAL.md	**PDF**
Editorial & Publishing Guide	Lifecycle, evidence, AI limits, human review, media, layout, release, corrections, QR and e-paper	03-EDITORIAL-AND-PUBLISHING-GUIDE.md	**PDF**

Document	What it covers	Markdown	PDF
Installation & Maintenance	Installer, components, locations, update, backup, restore, uninstall, disk, background operation, network and privacy	04-INSTALLATION-AND-MAINTENANCE.md	**PDF**
Troubleshooting & FAQ	Symptom → cause → safe steps → escalation	05-TROUBLESHOOTING-AND-FAQ.md	**PDF**
Combined handbook	All six documents in one bound volume	—	**PDF**
Documentation README	File map, screenshot credits and regeneration notes	README.md	—

The PDFs are generated from the Markdown files. If a PDF and its Markdown disagree, the Markdown is the source of truth.

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3. Verified scope

The following were exercised or directly inspected for this documentation:

- the packaged `Newsroom.exe` running against a disposable demonstration profile;
- first-run setup, sign-in, Dashboard, Sources, Stories, Articles, Build, Editions, Jobs, Schedules, AI Models, Connections, Media cache, Branding, Appearance, Users, Audit and Diagnostics screens;
- a real fixture build that produced job #1 and edition #2 in **Awaiting review**;
- a previously published five-page synthetic edition, its **Published PDF** and its **E-paper**;
- the edition workspace, article editor, evidence record, review items and release controls;
- the installer configuration, install paths, upgrade prompt and legacy shortcut cleanup;
- the Windows release report and the packaged file inventory.

3.1 Not verified

These are described only as far as the interface or configuration supports them, and are marked unverified where relevant:

- live Telegram login and retrieval (API id/hash were not configured);
- a clean-machine WebView2 bootstrap;
- unattended scheduled builds while the application is closed;
- AI model download, inference and the local model test end to end;
- automatic external research providers;
- font import and print-proof rendering end to end;
- media cache deletion;
- backup restore and a full update/uninstall cycle;
- the complete multi-user permission matrix;
- public QR targets and public source-list hosting;
- PDF composition certification beyond visual inspection, text selection and page geometry.

The internal record is in VERIFICATION-NOTES.md.

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4. Conventions used in these manuals

- **Bold** marks a UI label, button, field or exact status, for example **Queue build** or **Awaiting review**.
- `Monospace` marks a path, file name, model name or literal value.
- **Figure N.** captions describe real screenshots from a disposable demonstration profile.
- All demonstration content is synthetic. The app labels it **Synthetic demonstration edition**.
- The Newsroom name and logo identify the software and these manuals. They do not belong inside a customer newspaper's masthead.

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5. Product identity

Item	Value
Product name	**Newsroom**
Version	1.0.0
Platform	Windows 10 or Windows 11, 64-bit
Installer	`NewsroomSetup.exe`
Default install folder	`%LOCALAPPDATA%\Programs\Newsroom`
Default data folder	`%LOCALAPPDATA%\ChannelPress`
Published output	`%LOCALAPPDATA%\ChannelPress\output`
Logs	`%LOCALAPPDATA%\ChannelPress\logs`
Official palette	Ink `#20272B`, Paper `#F3F0E8`, Oxblood `#913E36`, Slate `#758089`

Newsroom was formerly distributed as **Channel Press**. The data folder name and some internal identifiers retain the old name for compatibility; they are not the current product name.

---

6. Getting help

If a procedure does not match your screen:

1. Note the exact screen name and the label you see.
2. Note the product version from **Diagnostics → About Newsroom**.
3. If a job failed, note its number, stage and error text.
4. Read the matching section of **Troubleshooting & FAQ**.

5. Before sending logs, remove personal data, phone numbers, API credentials, session contents and any unpublished reporting.

Do not delete the database, the data folder or the Telegram session file as a first response. Most problems are recoverable without data loss.

Quick Start

Install Newsroom and produce a first edition

Product: Newsroom 1.0.0 for Windows
Audience: A new owner or editor installing Newsroom on a Windows PC
Last verified against: `NewsroomSetup.exe` 1.0.0 and the packaged `Newsroom.exe` build of 31 October 2026

This guide takes you from the installer to a first edition preview and a published e-paper bundle. It uses the synthetic demonstration channel that ships with the application, so you can practise the whole workflow without connecting a real Telegram account or publishing anything.

> **Important:** The demonstration channel is invented test data. It is labelled **Synthetic demonstration edition** and must not be presented as journalism. Your own publication keeps its own name, masthead and branding; the Newsroom identity belongs to the software only.

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1. Before you install

What you need

Item	Requirement
Windows	Windows 10 or Windows 11, 64-bit
Installer	`NewsroomSetup.exe` (version 1.0.0)
Account type	A normal user account. The installer is per-user and does not require an administrator.
Disk space	About 1 GB for the installed application, plus room for your editions, media and any local AI models
Display	A window at least 1024 × 700; the default window is 1440 × 940
Internet	Needed for the installer to fetch Microsoft Edge WebView2 if it is missing, and for optional model downloads or live Telegram access. Editing and viewing already-downloaded editions work locally.

Newsroom does **not** bundle Ollama or AI model weights. A local AI model is an optional, separate download of 2.68–6.55 GB, and it is only usable when Ollama is installed and reachable on the same PC. The fixture demonstration and PDF/e-paper workflow do not need a model.

If you already use Channel Press

Newsroom is the current name of the application formerly distributed as Channel Press. The installer recognises an existing Channel Press installation, replaces the old shortcuts and executable names, and keeps the existing data folder. Do not uninstall the old application first, and do not delete its data folder. See **Installation & Maintenance** for the upgrade details.

2. Install Newsroom

1. Double-click `NewsroomSetup.exe`.
2. If Windows asks for permission, allow the setup to run. The installer is per-user and normally does not show an administrator prompt.
3. On the welcome page, choose **Next**.
4. Keep the default destination folder, `%LOCALAPPDATA%\Programs\Newsroom`, unless you have a specific reason to change it. The folder is private to your Windows account.
5. On the shortcut page, leave **Create a desktop shortcut** selected if you want one. A Start Menu shortcut named **Newsroom** is always created.
6. Choose **Install** and wait for the files to copy. If Microsoft Edge WebView2 Runtime is missing, setup runs Microsoft's signed WebView2 bootstrapper. This can take a few minutes and needs an internet connection.
7. Leave **Launch Newsroom** selected and choose **Finish**.

What you should see: a single window titled **Newsroom** opens. There is no terminal window, no browser address bar and no separate worker console. If the window shows a startup error, see **Troubleshooting & FAQ**.

Where the application is installed

Item	Default location
Program files	`%LOCALAPPDATA%\Programs\Newsroom`
Start Menu shortcut	**Newsroom**
Desktop shortcut	Optional, if selected during setup
Your data	`%LOCALAPPDATA%\ChannelPress`
Published editions	`%LOCALAPPDATA%\ChannelPress\output`
Logs	`%LOCALAPPDATA%\ChannelPress\logs`

`%LOCALAPPDATA%` is usually `C:\Users\<your Windows user>\AppData\Local`. You can paste the path into File Explorer's address bar.

3. Complete first-run setup

The first time Newsroom opens, it shows **Set up Newsroom** instead of the sign-in page.

1. Leave **Owner username** as `owner`, or enter a name you will remember.
2. Enter a **Display name**, for example `Editor in Chief`. This name appears in the header and audit trail.
3. Enter a **Password** of at least 12 characters, then repeat it in **Confirm password**.

4. Leave **Create the synthetic fixture channel for the local demo** selected if you want to follow this guide exactly. Clear it if you are setting up a real publication and will import your own authorised content.
5. Choose **Create owner and continue**.

What you should see: the sign-in page with the Newsroom wordmark.

> **Keep the password safe.** There is no email-based password reset in the installed application. An owner can reset another user's password from **Users**, but losing the only owner password requires help from whoever maintains the installation.

Sign in

1. Enter the username and password you just created.
2. Choose **Sign in**.

The sign-in page warns that five failed attempts in 15 minutes trigger a temporary lockout. Wait for the lockout period to pass before trying again. Usernames are not case-sensitive; passwords are.

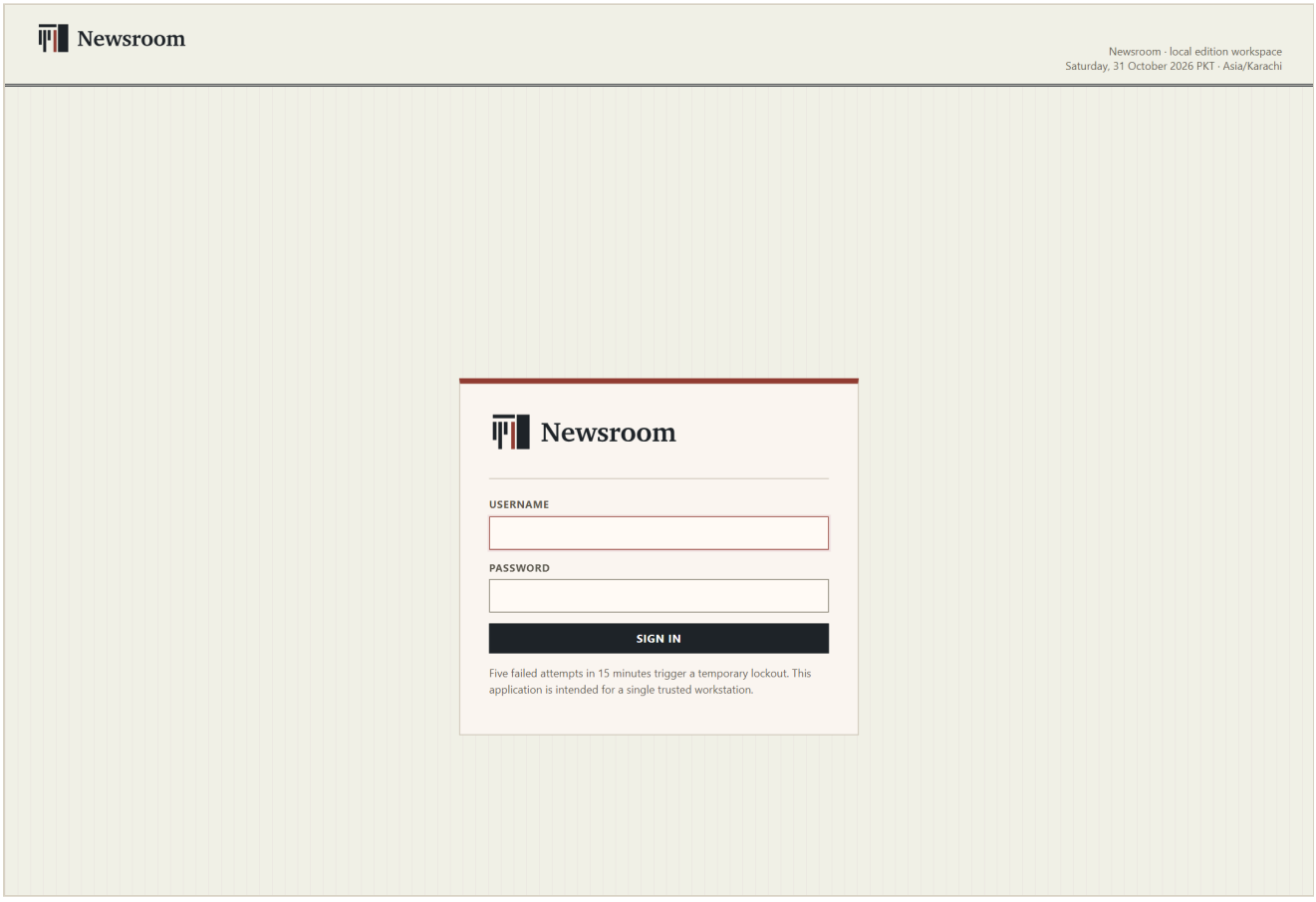


Figure 1. The Newsroom sign-in page. The application runs locally in one window.

4. Look around the workspace

After sign-in, the **Dashboard** is your starting point. The header shows:

- the **Newspaper** selector and **Switch** button;
- the current date and time zone;
- your display name and role;
- the main navigation: **Dashboard**, **Sources**, **Stories**, **Articles**, **Build**, **Editions**, **Schedules**, **Jobs**, **AI Models**, **Connections**, **Media cache**, **Branding**, **Appearance**, **Users**, **Audit** and **Diagnostics**.

Some items only appear for roles that can use them. In the tested owner account, every section was visible. The footer repeats the current publication name and the statement **Data stays on this computer.**

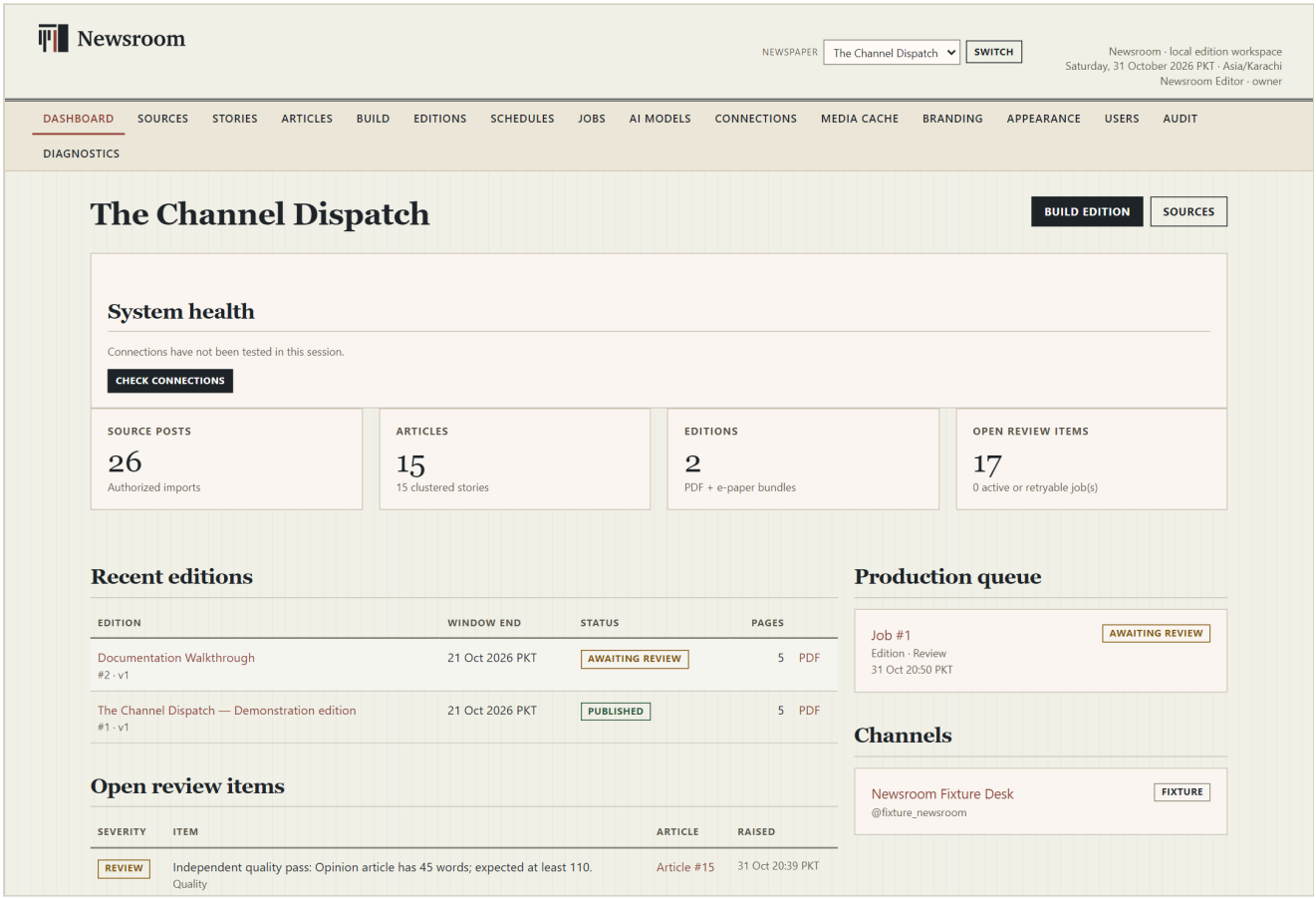


Figure 2. The Dashboard after a fixture edition has been built. The production queue shows the last job.

The Dashboard summarises:

Area	What it tells you
System health	Whether connections have been checked in this session. Choose **Check connections** to run the read-only checks.
Source posts / Articles / Editions	Counts of stored posts, clustered stories and editions.
Open review items	Editorial or quality items that still need a decision.
Recent editions	The latest editions and their status.

Area	What it tells you
Production queue	Recent build jobs and their state.
Channels	Sources authorised for this newspaper.

Switch newspapers

If more than one newspaper exists, choose it in the **Newspaper** list and select **Switch**. This changes the working newspaper; it does not publish anything. Each newspaper has its own branding, sources, schedules, drafts, editions and archive.

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5. Optional: make local AI ready

You can skip this section for the fixture demonstration. The fixture composer writes deterministic drafts and does not use a model.

Newsroom does not install Ollama or download model weights by itself. To use a local Qwen3.5 model:

1. Make sure Ollama is installed and running on the same PC. Newsroom deliberately does not start an Ollama service it does not own.
2. In Newsroom, open **AI Models**.
3. Check the model cards. The three reviewed profiles are:

Profile	Model	Download	Suggested hardware
Standard · Recommended	`qwen3.5:4b-q4_K_M`	3.32 GB	6 GB VRAM / 8 GB RAM
Enhanced	`qwen3.5:9b-q4_K_M`	6.55 GB	12 GB VRAM / 16 GB RAM
Compact	`qwen3.5:2b`	2.68 GB	4 GB VRAM / 8 GB RAM

4. On the model you want, tick **I approve downloading … from the verified Ollama registry**, then choose **Verify and download**. The transfer can take a long time and uses disk space outside the Newsroom data folder.
5. When the profile shows as installed, choose **Select profile**.
6. Choose **Test local model** and wait for the synthetic test to finish.

Success check: the selected model is shown as the current model and its readiness says the local test passed. Until then, source drafting is not considered ready.

> **Hardware note:** the suggested figures are guidance, not guarantees. A 9B model on a 6 GB GPU may be slow or may not fit. Compact is a reduced-capability fallback, not an automatic replacement. AI drafts always need human review.

If **AI Models** says **Local AI runtime unavailable**, the Ollama service is not reachable. See **Troubleshooting & FAQ**.

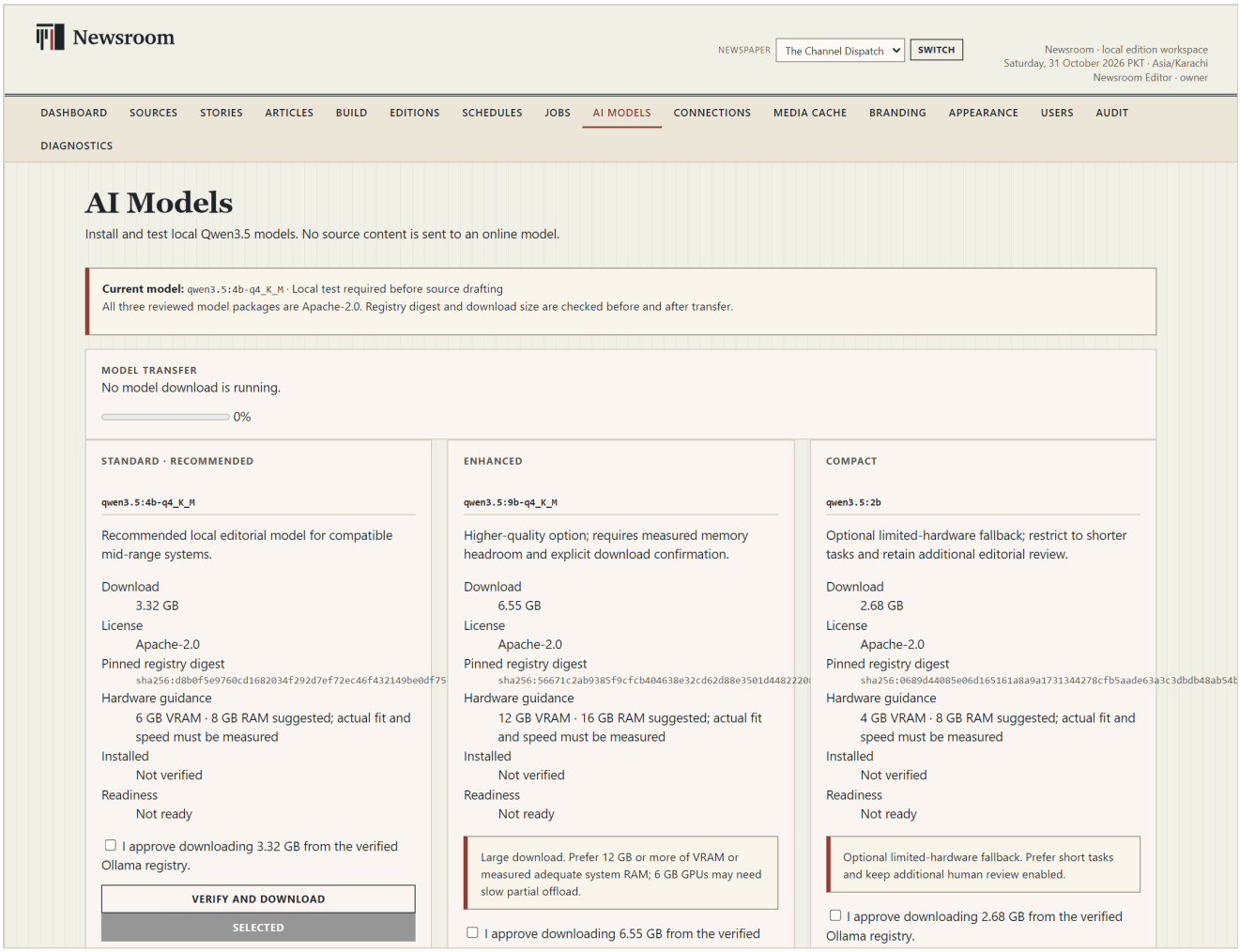


Figure 3. The AI Models page. Models are optional local downloads; the installer does not bundle them.

6. Add an authorised source

Newsroom can work from two kinds of source:

- the **synthetic fixture desk**, which is for practice and is labelled as invented content;
- a **live import** of an export you are authorised to republish.

Public read access to a Telegram channel is **not** permission to republish it. Newsroom asks for a rights declaration before it will treat a live channel as a source.

Register a channel and record rights

1. Open **Sources**.
2. Under **Register an authorized channel**, enter:
   - **Channel title** — the name shown inside Newsroom;
   - **Internal slug** — a short local identifier;
   - **Telegram handle** — optional, for example `@channel`;
   - **Channel has a public t.me address** — tick only if that is true;

- **Grantor (person or organisation)** — who granted permission;
- **Authority basis** — for example, owner of the channel or written permission with a date;
- **Evidence reference** — where the written permission is filed. 3. Choose **Register channel**.

What you should see: the new channel appears on the **Source desk** with its rights status. A missing rights declaration is shown in red and blocks live builds.

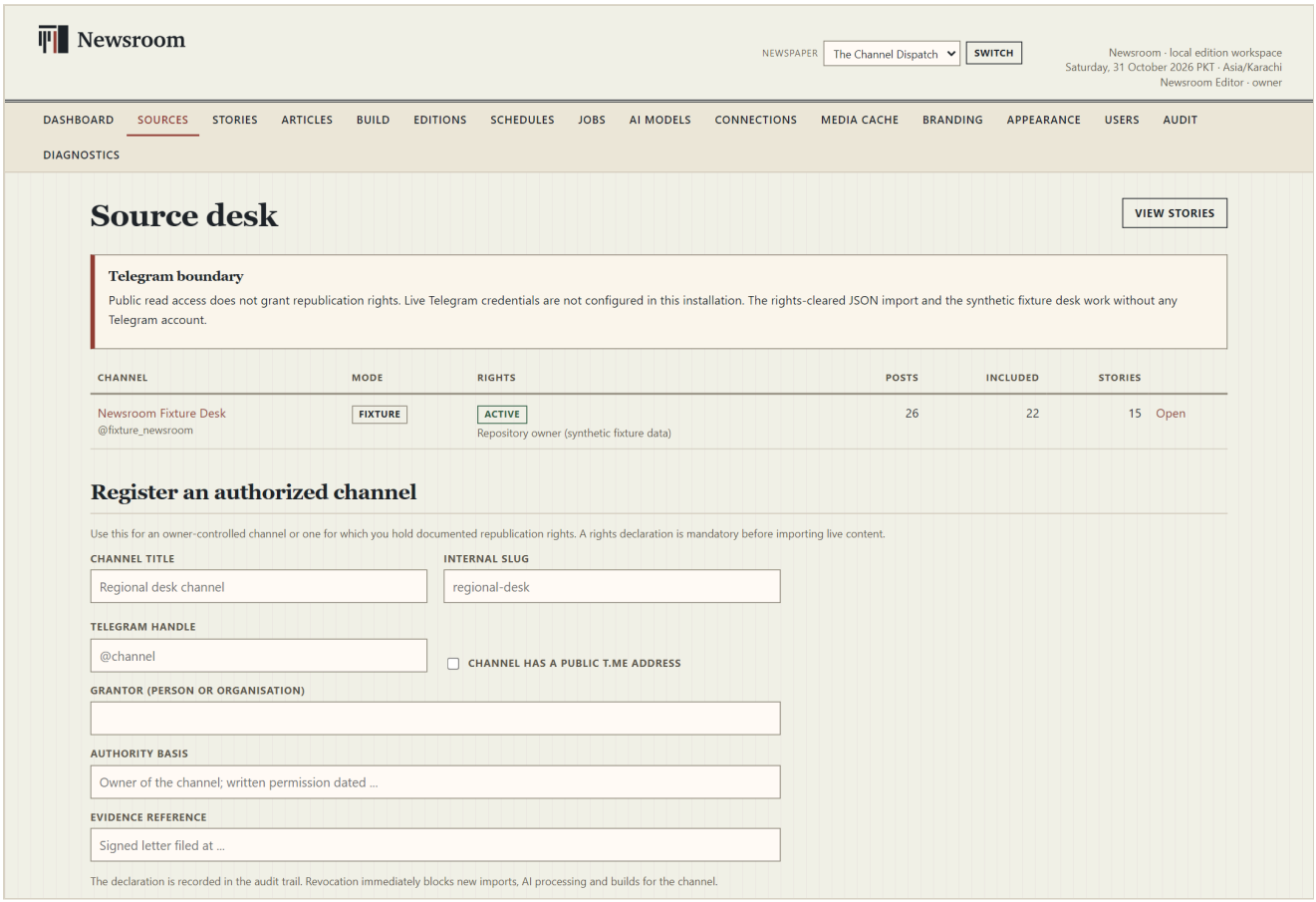


Figure 4. The Source desk. The fixture channel is an example; the registration form creates a live-import source.

Import an authorised export

1. Open the channel from the Source desk.
2. Find **Import authorized content**.
3. Choose the **JSON export** file. The owner import format and Telegram Desktop JSON export are supported, up to 40 MB.
4. Optionally choose **Referenced media files** so captions and credits stay linked to the original message.
5. Choose **Import**.

The import summary shows how many posts were read, accepted and excluded. Exclusion is normal: greetings, promotions, link-only posts, forwarded copies, empty messages and similar items are left out with a recorded reason. Open a post's **Why this classification** and use **Editor decision** if a decision is wrong.

Telegram connection

The installed build includes a **Telegram connection** page for each channel. It exposes the channel handle, **Test source connection**, phone-number sign-in, **Request login code**, **Submit code**, **Finish sign-in**, **Cancel login**, **Import last 30 days (context only)**, **Sync window**, and **Sign out**.

Live Telegram access also requires an API id/hash that the installer does not request or configure in the normal interface. If the page reports **Missing** or **API id/hash are not configured**, live collection is not available on that installation. The verified route in this build is the rights-cleared JSON import; live Telegram login and retrieval could not be verified for this documentation. Do not paste login codes or two-step passwords into chat, email or a support message.

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7. Create or adjust your publication identity

1. Open **Branding**.
2. Set at least:
   - **Publication name** — the masthead name of your newspaper;
   - **Byline (printed under every headline)**;
   - **City**;
   - **Timezone (IANA)** — for example `Asia/Karachi`;
   - **Paper size** — **Tabloid 11 × 17 in** or **A3 297 × 420 mm**;
   - **Volume number**;
   - **Source code policy** and **Public evidence-page base URL** only if you genuinely publish evidence pages. 3. Review **Section order** and the **Automatic research** policy. 4. Choose **Save publication profile**.

Success check: the newspaper name in the header and on the Dashboard changes to the name you saved. Existing published editions keep the identity they were printed with.

To create a second newspaper, use **New newspaper** at the bottom of **Branding**. Each newspaper has its own sources, schedules, drafts and archive.

> Do not put the Newsroom logo into your newspaper. The Newsroom identity identifies the software and these manuals; your publication's masthead is your own.

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8. Build your first edition

The demonstration channel already contains sample posts. This walkthrough produced an actual five-page tabloid edition from synthetic fixture data in the tested build.

1. Open **Build**.
2. Choose **Newsroom Fixture Desk (fixture)** as the **Primary source channel**.

3. The fixture window is filled from the sample posts. For a manual walkthrough, set:
    - **Window start** to the beginning of the sample day;
    - **Window end / cutoff** to the following midnight. 4. Enter an **Edition name**, for example `Documentation Walkthrough`. 5. Choose **Queue build**.

What you should see: Newsroom opens a job page with a message such as **Build queued. Worker started in the background**. The job moves through classification, normalization, clustering, drafting and layout. A fixture build typically finishes in well under a minute; a live build with media and a local model can take much longer.

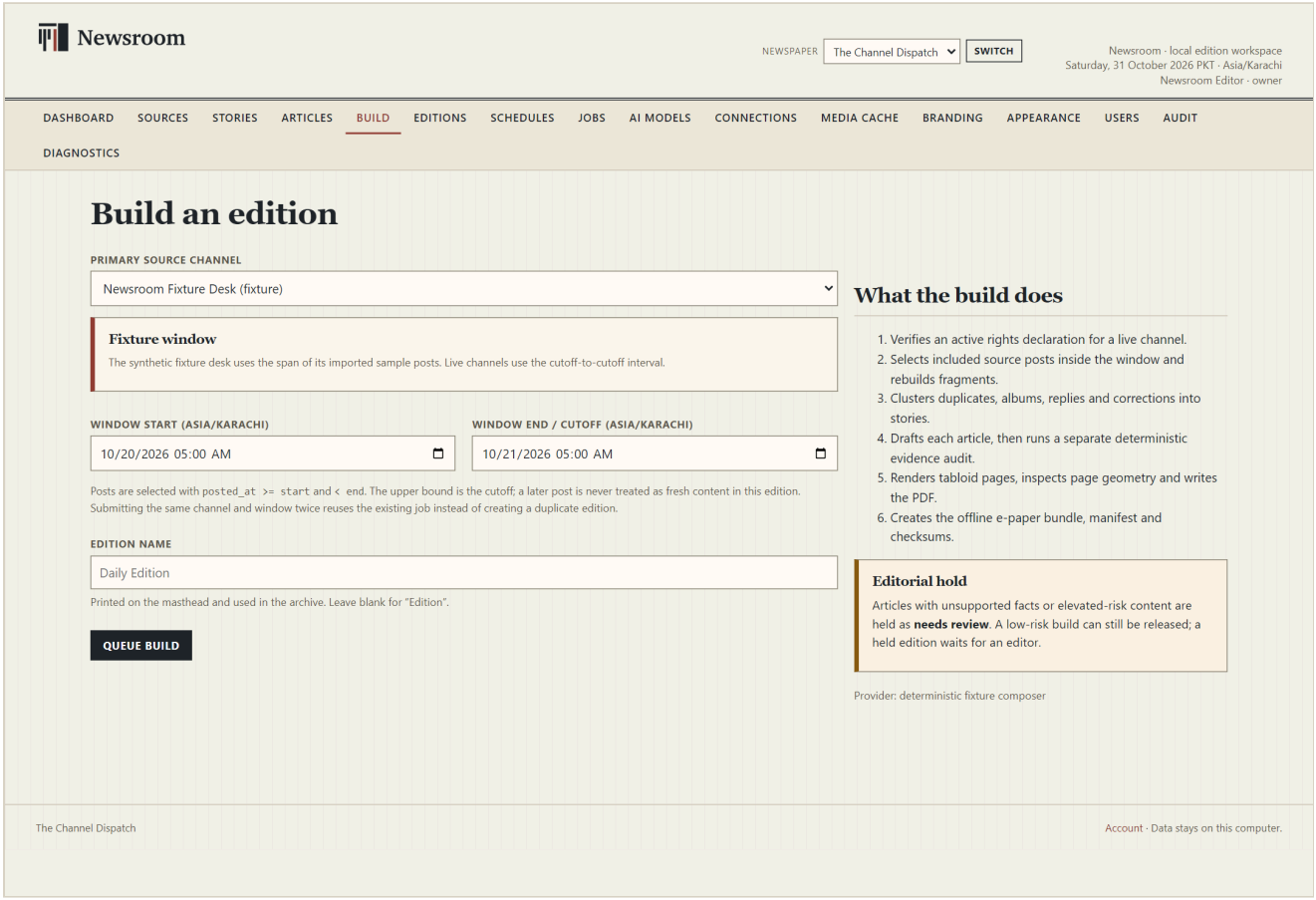


Figure 5. The Build page. The window end is the cutoff; posts at exactly that instant belong to the next issue.

Follow the job

Open **Jobs** to see queued and recent jobs. A row shows the job number, kind, channel, status, stage, progress, attempt, scheduled time, finish time and any error.

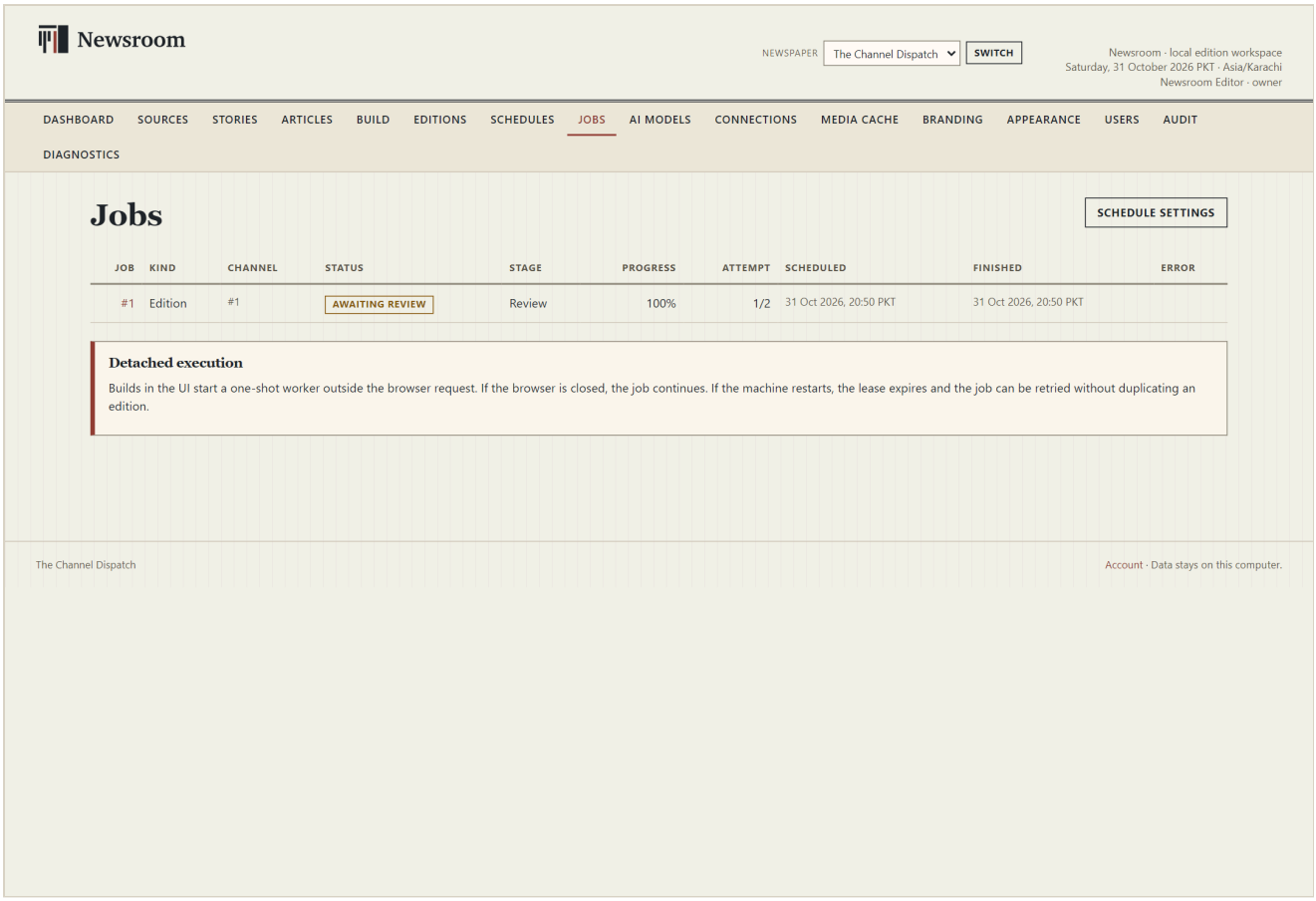


Figure 6. Jobs after a fixture build. The job finished in Awaiting review, not as a published edition.

A finished build normally ends in **Awaiting review**. That means the pages and PDF preview exist, but the edition has not been released. This is deliberate: the review step is where a person checks the copy, evidence, images and layout.

> **Do not close the window with the X while a build is running unless you choose carefully.** Closing offers **Continue in background**, **Pause safely and exit**, and **Keep open**. **Continue in background** hides the window but leaves the local service and queued work running. **Pause safely and exit** waits for safe checkpoints before stopping. See section 11.

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9. Review the edition and open the preview

1. Open **Editions**.
2. Choose the new edition. Its status is **Awaiting review**.
3. The edition workspace lists all articles on the left, the selected article in the middle and **Newspaper preview** on the right.
4. Read the **Release held** panel. It names every open review item that must be resolved before release. Typical items include an elevated-risk story, an anonymous or unverified claim, or a quality pass that finds the article shorter than its genre expects.

5. Select an article and review its **Draft text**, **Source evidence**, **Claims**, **Chronology**, **Revision history** and **Published snapshot** (for a previously published version).
6. Use **Open preview PDF** to inspect the actual rendered pages. Use **Rebuild preview only** after changing copy if the page preview is out of date.



Figure 7. An edition held for review. The preview and PDF exist, but release is blocked until the listed items are decided.

Resolve review items

For each article:

1. Open the article from the edition workspace or **Articles**.
2. Read **Draft text** and compare it with **Source evidence**.
3. In **Review items**, choose **Approve item** or **Reject item** and add a short decision note where prompted.
4. Use **Re-run independent audit** if you have changed the text and want a fresh audit.
5. Set **Article status** to **Approved** when the item is ready. **Hold**, **Needs research**, **Excluded** and **Draft** are also available.
6. Return to the edition and choose **Rebuild preview only** if the copy changed.

The exact number of items depends on the articles. A risk item is not a formality: confirm attribution, wording and whether the story should run at all.

Success check: the **Release held** panel no longer lists blockers, and **Release version 1** becomes available. If it remains disabled, open each article and resolve the remaining review items.

---

10. Release the edition and find the PDF and e-paper

When the edition is clean:

1. In the edition workspace, choose **Release version 1** under **Release**.
2. **What you should see:** the status becomes **Published** and an **Immutable release** badge appears. The edition and its manifest can no longer be changed.

Published files are available from the edition:

Button	What it opens
Published PDF	The frozen tabloid PDF
E-paper	The offline page-turner and text edition
Open preview PDF	The working preview, when one exists

You can also open **Editions** and use the **PDF** or **E-paper** links in the row.

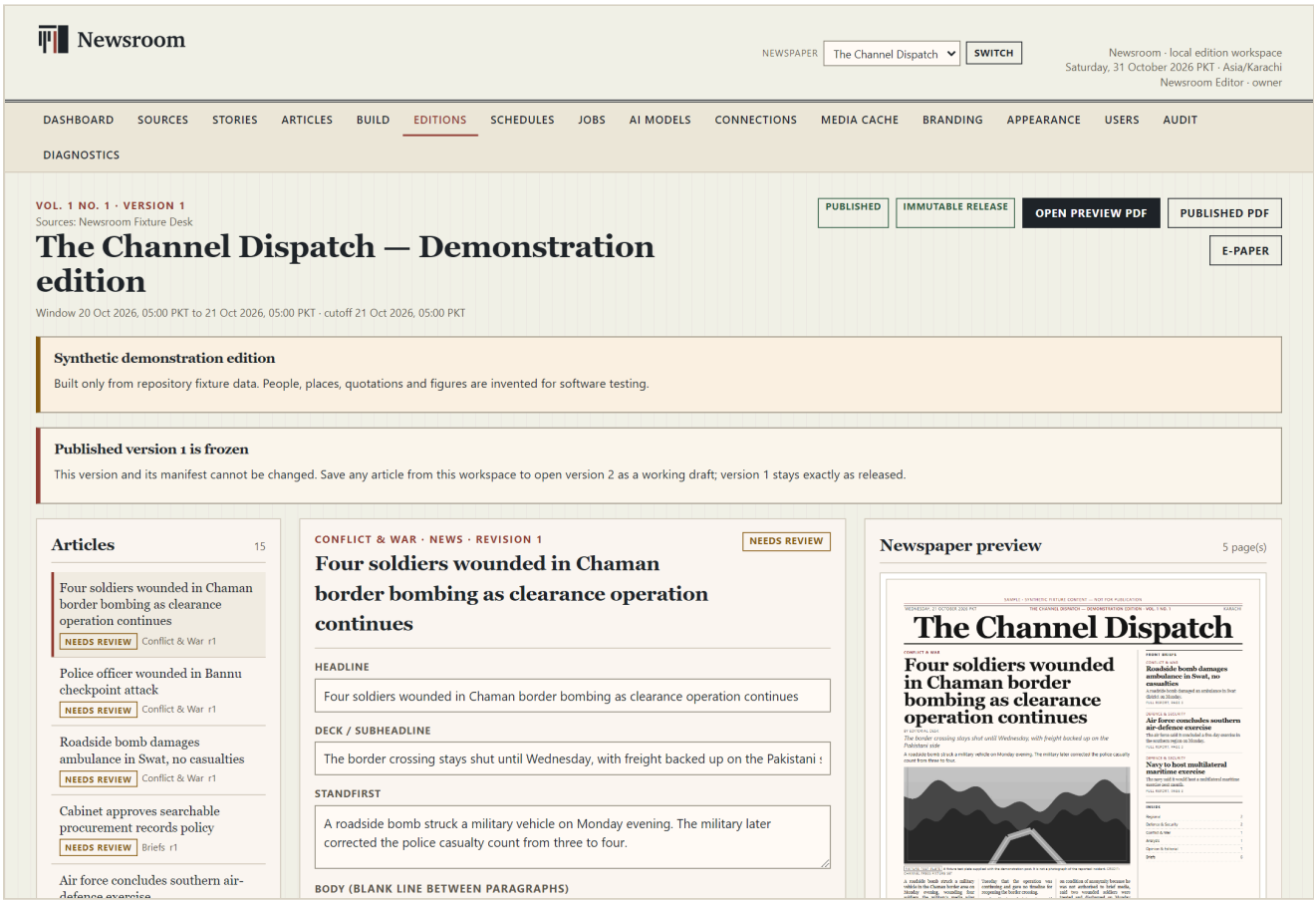


Figure 8. The edition workspace. Articles, page preview, quality summary and release controls are on one screen.

The e-paper

The e-paper is a self-contained bundle. It includes page navigation, a text edition and a source appendix. Open it from the edition's **E-paper** button. The same files are in the edition folder on disk, so the bundle can be opened without the Newsroom server.



Figure 9. The e-paper viewer for a published edition, with page navigation and a source appendix.

Where the files are

Published editions are stored under:

```
%LOCALAPPDATA%\ChannelPress\output\<publication-slug>\<edition-folder>\
```

A typical edition folder contains the PDF, page proofs, the e-paper bundle, a manifest and checksums. The exact folder name is shown in the edition's **Provenance** section. Do not rename or edit files inside a published edition folder; that would break its checksums.



SYNTHETIC FIXTURE EDITION — NOT FOR PUBLICATION. SOURCE POSTS ARE SYNTHETIC TEST DATA.

WEDNESDAY, 21 OCTOBER 2026 PKT · MANUAL EDITION · VOL. 1 NO. 1 · KARACHI

The Channel Dispatch

A source-transparent roundup for the region · @fixture_newsroom

CONFLICT & WAR

Four soldiers wounded in Chaman border bombing as clearance operation continues

BY EDITORIAL DESK

The border crossing stays shut until Wednesday, with freight backed up on the Pakistani side

A roadside bomb struck a military vehicle on Monday evening. The military later corrected the police casualty count from three to four.

FIXTURE TEST PLATE A fixture test plate supplied with the demonstration post. It is not a photograph of the reported incident. CREDIT: CHANNEL PRESS FIXTURE SET

A roadside bomb struck a military vehicle in the Chaman border area on Monday evening, wounding four soldiers, the military's media wing said, correcting an earlier police count of three.

Security forces launched a clearance operation after the blast, the provincial counterterrorism department said. The military said on Tuesday that the operation was continuing and gave no timeline for reopening the border crossing.

The district administration said the crossing would remain closed until Wednesday morning. Traders said hundreds of trucks were waiting on the Pakistani side.

Two of the wounded soldiers were in stable condition at a Quetta hospital, according to the military account. A hospital official, speaking on condition of anonymity because he was not authorised to brief media, said two wounded soldiers were treated and discharged on Monday night. That account could not be independently corroborated.

No group had claimed responsibility.

The channel initially reported that the operation had ended, then published a correction saying it was continuing.

CHRONOLOGY

20 Oct, 11:10	Security forces launched a clearance operation in the Chaman border area on Monday evening after a roadside bomb struck a military vehicle, the provincial counterterrorism department said.	ATTRIBUTED
20 Oct, 12:05	Correction published: Update: The military's media wing says four soldiers were wounded, correcting an earlier police count of three.	CORRECTED
20 Oct, 12:40	Photographs released by the department show the damaged vehicle and security personnel at the scene.	REPORTED
20 Oct, 13:20	The district administration said the border crossing would remain closed until Wednesday morning.	ATTRIBUTED
20 Oct, 14:02	A hospital official, speaking on condition of anonymity because he was not authorised to brief media, said two of the wounded soldiers were treated and discharged on Monday night.	ATTRIBUTED
20 Oct, 15:15	The military's media wing confirmed on Tuesday that four soldiers were wounded in the Chaman roadside bombing and that a clearance operation was continuing.	REPORTED

Showing the first 6 of 7 dated entries. The remaining 1 are held in the edition source record and are not printed here.

Sources: A1, A2, A3, A4 and 3 more · appendix p. 5

The channel published a correction to an earlier report. This article uses the corrected figure and records the change in its source appendix.

FRONT BRIEFS

CONFLICT & WAR
Police officer wounded in Bannu checkpoint attack
Gunmen attacked a checkpoint in Bannu district on Monday, wounding one police officer, police said.
FULL REPORT, PAGE 3

CONFLICT & WAR
Roadside bomb damages ambulance in Swat, no casualties
A roadside bomb damaged an ambulance in Swat district on Monday.
FULL REPORT, PAGE 3

DEFENCE & SECURITY
Air force concludes southern air-defence exercise
The air force said it concluded a five-day exercise in the southern region on Monday.
FULL REPORT, PAGE 2

DEFENCE & SECURITY
Navy to host multilateral maritime exercise
The navy said it would host a multilateral maritime exercise next month.
FULL REPORT, PAGE 2

INSIDE

Regional	2
Defence & Security	2
Conflict & War	2
Analysis	1
Opinion & Editorial	1
Briefs	6
Sources & provenance	appendix

About this edition. This edition is an editorial roundup based primarily on authorized posts published by the owner's source channel; it is not staffed eyewitness journalism. Compiled from @fixture_newsroom by the Editorial Desk. Every factual statement is traced to a dated source message in the appendix; analysis and opinion are labelled. This is a synthetic demonstration edition built only from repository fixture data. It is not a real news report and must not be published as journalism.

MORE FROM THIS EDITION

BRIEFS
Cabinet approves searchable procurement records policy
The federal cabinet approved a national digital records policy on Tuesday, requiring ministries to...
FULL REPORT, PAGE 4

BRIEFS
Pakistan and Iran agree to reopen border-trade talks
Pakistan and Iran agreed to reopen talks on border trade at a meeting in Tehran, the foreign ministry said.
FULL REPORT, PAGE 4

BRIEFS
State Bank holds policy rate at 19.5pc as food prices persist
The State Bank held its policy rate at 19.5 percent on Monday, citing persistent inflation.
FULL REPORT, PAGE 4

BRIEFS
Market reopens after repairs, committee says
A local market reopened after repairs on Tuesday, the market committee said.
FULL REPORT, PAGE 4

BRIEFS
Flood compensation portal still rejecting claims, applicants say
The provincial government's flood compensation portal is still rejecting applications from last year's...
FULL REPORT, PAGE 4

BRIEFS
Border closure hurts traders, association says
The closure of the border trade route has hurt traders, a local traders' association said.
FULL REPORT, PAGE 4

Figure 10. A page from the published tabloid PDF. The newspaper uses its own masthead, not the Newsroom logo.

11. Close, reopen and keep work safe

Closing the window with the X does not simply quit. Newsroom asks what should happen to work that is still running:

Choice	Result
Continue in background	Hides the window and leaves the local service and queued work running. Launch Newsroom again to restore the existing window.

Choice	Result
Pause safely and exit	Waits for the worker and model operations to reach safe checkpoints, then closes the window and stops the local service. This can take a little time.
Keep open	Returns to the application without closing anything.

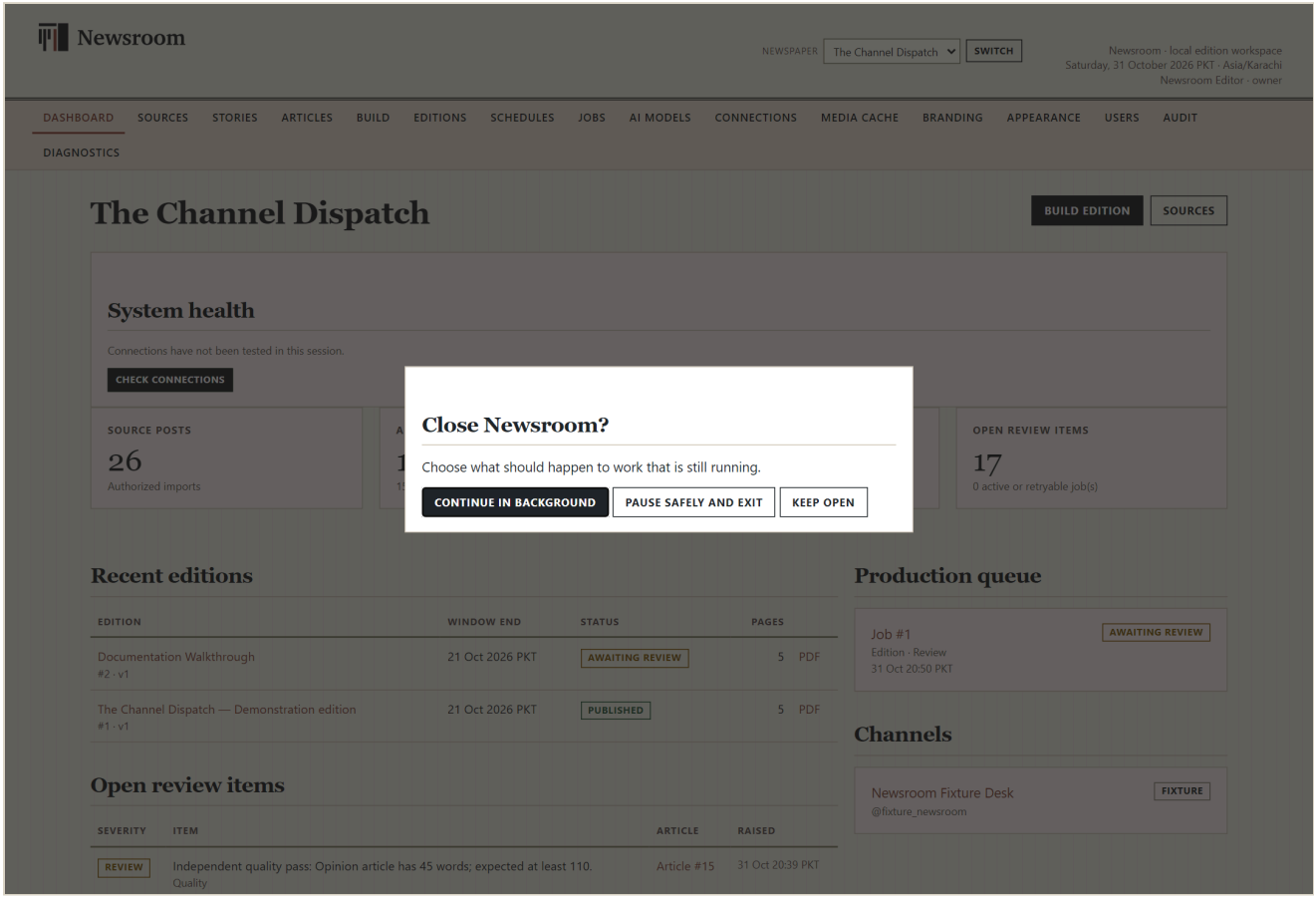


Figure 11. The close choice. "Continue in background" keeps work alive; "Pause safely and exit" stops at a checkpoint.

Only one Newsroom window can run at a time. If you launch the application again while it is in the background, Newsroom focuses the existing window rather than starting a second copy. This protects the database and the Telegram session.

Success checklist

- [ ] Newsroom opens in one **Newsroom** window with no console.
- [ ] You can sign in with your owner account.
- [ ] The Dashboard shows your newspaper and its counts.
- [ ] Your source appears in **Sources** with a rights status.
- [ ] A build reaches **Awaiting review** or **Published** without an unexplained error.
- [ ] The edition preview opens and shows real pages.
- [ ] A released edition has a **Published PDF** and an **E-paper** link.
- [ ] The e-paper opens and its pages and sources are readable.
- [ ] You know where `%LOCALAPPDATA%\ChannelPress` is and how to back it up.

If any step does not match, go to **Troubleshooting & FAQ** before deleting data or reinstalling.

---

12. What this build does not do

Be aware of these limits before relying on Newsroom for a real issue:

- **No cloud account, subscription or external publishing.** Editions are released locally; there is no automatic upload to a website or social network.
- **No bundled AI.** Local models are separate Ollama downloads and may not fit your hardware. AI output is assistive and requires editorial review.
- **No guaranteed live Telegram access.** The Telegram connection page exists, but the API credentials are not set by the installer. Live login and retrieval were not verified in this documentation. The rights-cleared JSON import is the verified route.
- **No automatic unattended schedule when the app is closed.** A schedule defines the cutoff and window and can be run with **Run the latest cutoff now**; automatic background runs depend on a Windows task or another worker setup that this installer does not create. See **Installation & Maintenance**.
- **No EPUB, HTML newsletter or email export.** The verified outputs are the tabloid PDF, page proofs and the offline e-paper bundle.
- **No in-app backup button.** Back up by closing Newsroom and copying the data folder; see **Installation & Maintenance**.
- **The demonstration content is synthetic.** Never publish it as real reporting.

For the full control reference, continue with the **User Manual**. For editorial judgement and release practice, read the **Editorial & Publishing Guide**.

NEWSROOM · DOCUMENT 02

User Manual

The complete control reference

Product: Newsroom 1.0.0 for Windows
Audience: Owners, editors and operators who use Newsroom day to day
Last verified against: the packaged build of 31 October 2026, using a disposable demonstration profile

This manual is the control reference for the installed application. It explains each screen, the fields it exposes and the result you should expect. It does not teach installation, command-line tools or source-code development. For a first run, use **Quick Start**. For editorial judgement and release practice, use the **Editorial & Publishing Guide**.

> **About the illustrations:** every screenshot in this manual comes from a disposable demonstration profile. The newspaper, people, places, quotations and figures shown in it are synthetic test data. They are not reporting and must not be presented as news.

1. How Newsroom is organised

Newsroom is a single-window Windows application. The window contains a header, a navigation bar and a working area. All data stays on the computer. Editions are prepared, reviewed and released locally; there is no account, subscription or automatic upload to a website.

1.1 The header

The header is present on every screen:

Element	Meaning
Newspaper selector and **Switch**	Chooses which newspaper you are working in. Switching does not publish anything.
Date, time and time zone	The current local time in the newspaper's configured zone.
Your display name and role	For example `Newsroom Editor · owner`. The name also appears in the audit trail.
Navigation	The main sections listed below. Some items appear only for roles that can use them.
Footer	The current publication name and the statement **Data stays on this computer.**

1.2 Navigation

Section	What it is for
Dashboard	Health, counts, recent editions, open review items, the production queue and channels.
Sources	The source desk: authorised channels, rights declarations, imports, collection windows and source posts.
Stories	Clustered stories with claims, source fragments, research context and chronology.

Section	What it is for
Articles	The article list and the full article editor with audit and review controls.
Build	Queue a new edition from a source channel and a cutoff window.
Editions	The edition archive, release state and PDF/e-paper links.
Schedules	Cutoff and release times, review policy and catch-up controls.
Jobs	Build jobs, stages, progress, errors and recovery actions.
AI Models	Local Qwen3.5 model download, selection and readiness test.
Connections	Read-only checks for local services, storage, renderer and network access.
Media cache	A dry-run view of deletable media and protected media.
Branding	Publication identity, paper size, sections, research policy, newspapers, sources and editors.
Appearance	Colours, fonts, type metrics, print proof and theme revisions.
Users	Accounts, roles, passwords and access.
Audit	The local audit trail of actions.
Diagnostics	Component status, configuration values and data/privacy notes.

1.3 Roles

Newsroom exposes four roles: **Viewer**, **Operator**, **Editor** and **Owner**. In the tested owner account, every section was visible. Other roles may see fewer controls. The exact permission boundary for each role was not exhaustively tested for this manual; if a control is missing, check the role on **Users** before assuming a fault.

1.4 The working newspaper

Each newspaper has its own masthead and branding, source list, schedules, drafts, editions and archive. The **Newspaper** selector changes which one you are working in. A second newspaper is created from **Branding**, not by copying the data folder.

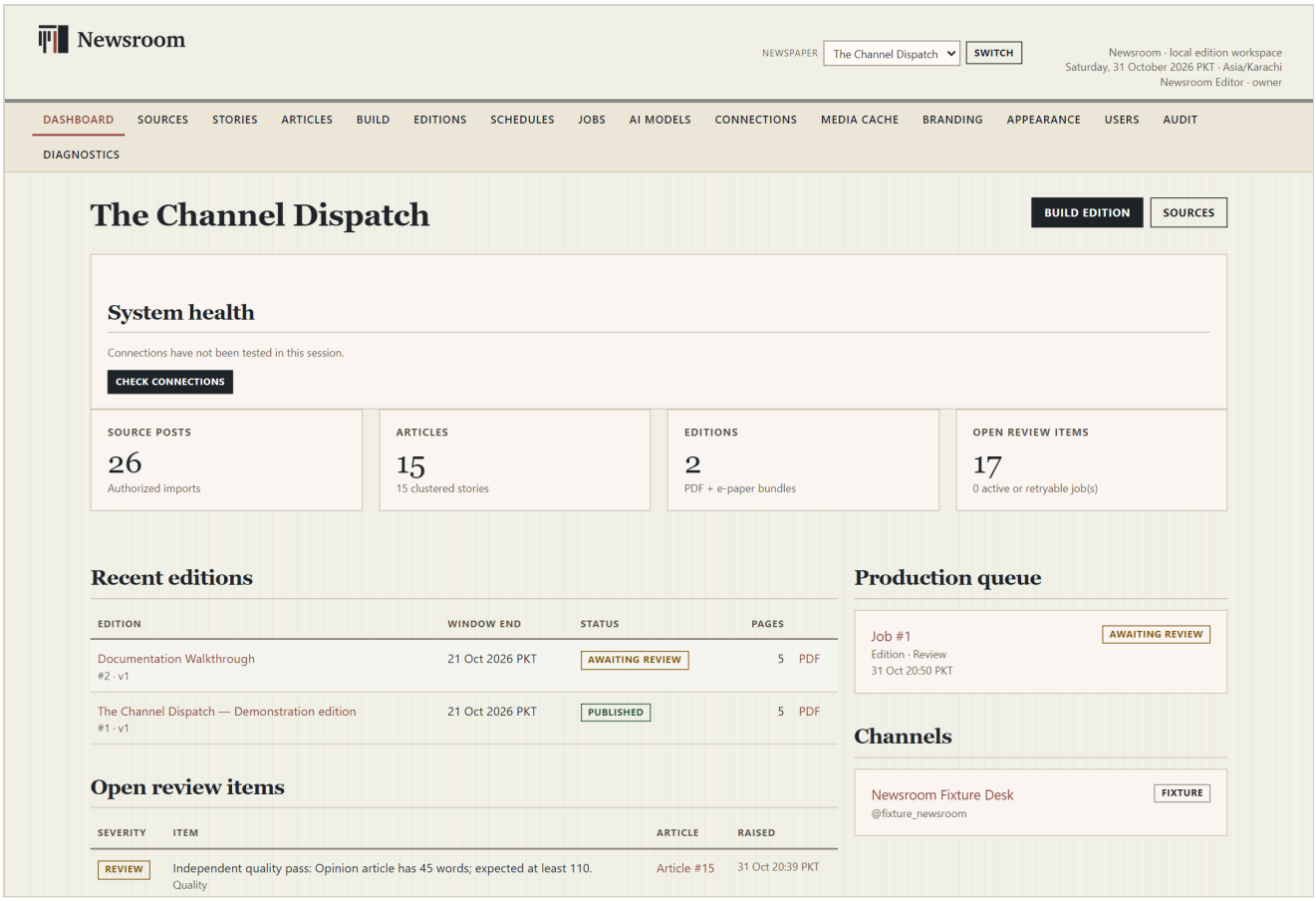


Figure 1. The Dashboard of the demonstration newspaper. The synthetic edition is published; review items and the production queue are visible.

2. Dashboard

The Dashboard answers three questions: is the installation healthy, what needs a decision, and what was produced recently.

2.1 System health

On a new session the panel says **Connections have not been tested in this session.** Choose **Check connections** to run the same read-only checks as the **Connections** page. The result is a status, a short explanation and a next step. The check does not download models, contact Telegram or change data.

2.2 Counts

Card	Meaning
Source posts	Stored posts from authorised imports, with the subtitle **Authorized imports**.
Articles	Draft and published article records, with the number of clustered stories underneath.
Editions	Editions in the archive, with the subtitle **PDF + e-paper bundles**.
Open review items	Editorial or quality items still awaiting a decision. The line underneath reports active or retryable jobs.

2.3 Recent editions

The table shows the edition name, window end, status, page count and a **PDF** link. A published edition is marked **PUBLISHED**. Select the edition name to open its workspace.

2.4 Open review items

Each row shows severity, the item text, the article number and when it was raised. Typical items are independent quality passes, for example:

> **REVIEW** Independent quality pass: Opinion article has 45 words; expected at least 110.

Select the article to open it and decide the item. Quality items are advisory in tone but they still block release until they are approved or rejected.

2.5 Production queue and channels

The production queue lists recent jobs. If nothing has run, it says **No jobs recorded.** The **Channels** panel lists the sources authorised for this newspaper, their mode and handle. A fixture channel is marked **FIXTURE**.

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3. Sources

Sources is the source desk. It is where a channel becomes an authorised source, where its rights are recorded and revoked, and where imported posts are inspected.

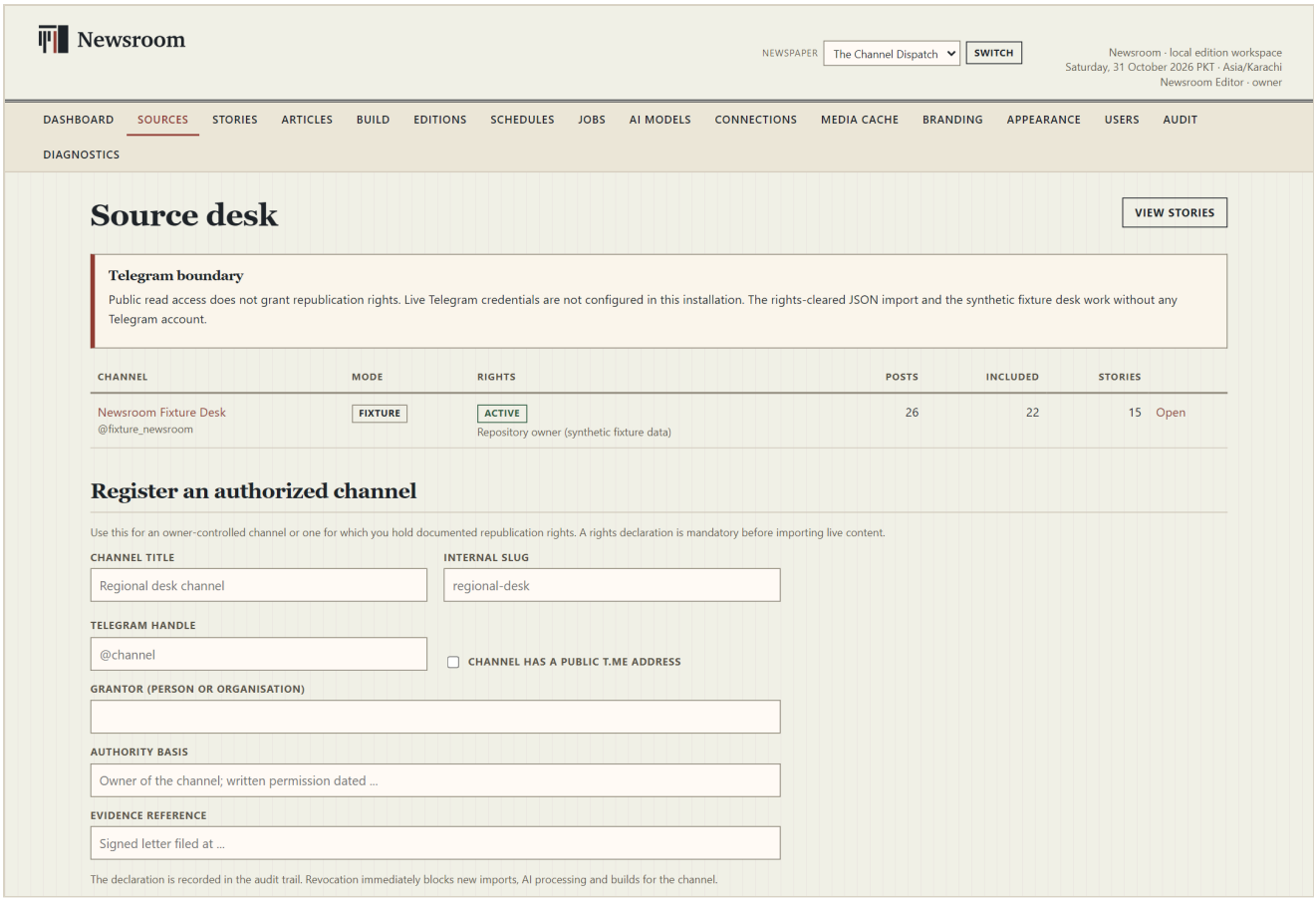


Figure 2. The Source desk. The synthetic fixture channel is listed with its rights status, counts and an Open link.

3.1 The Telegram boundary

The page states the rule plainly:

> Public read access does not grant republication rights. Live Telegram credentials are not configured in this installation. The rights-cleared JSON import and the synthetic fixture desk work without any Telegram account.

Treat this as an editorial rule, not only a technical one. A channel you can read is not a channel you may republish.

3.2 The channel table

Column	Meaning
Channel	Title and handle. Select **Open** to see the source detail.
Mode	`FIXTURE` for the synthetic desk or the live-import mode for an authorised channel.
Rights	`ACTIVE` when a rights declaration is in force.
Posts / Included / Stories	Stored post count, posts accepted into processing and clustered stories.

3.3 Register an authorised channel

Use **Register an authorized channel** for an owner-controlled channel, or one for which you hold documented republication rights. A rights declaration is mandatory before live content can be imported.

1. Enter **Channel title** — the name shown inside Newsroom.
2. Enter **Internal slug** — a short local identifier.
3. Enter **Telegram handle** — optional, for example `@channel`.
4. Tick **Channel has a public t.me address** only when that is true.
5. Enter **Grantor (person or organisation)**.
6. Enter **Authority basis** — for example, owner of the channel, or written permission with a date.
7. Enter **Evidence reference** — where the written permission is filed.
8. Choose **Register channel**.

What you should see: the channel appears on the Source desk with its rights status. The declaration is written to the audit trail. Revocation immediately blocks new imports, AI processing and builds for that channel.

> **Do not use a public channel you merely follow.** Permission to read is not permission to republish. If you cannot name the grantor and the evidence, do not register the channel as a source.

3.4 Source detail

Open a channel to reach its detail page.

Area	What it shows or does
Build from this channel	Opens **Build** with this channel selected.
Rights status	`Active` or the blocking state, with the grantor beneath it.
Reporting window available	The span of stored posts that can be used.
Access	The access note, for example **Owner** and **Private source; message IDs only**.
Open Telegram connection	Opens the channel's Telegram page.
Collection windows	Window, status, stored posts, fetched, included and excluded counts.
Import authorized content	The JSON import form.
Rights declarations	Grantor, authority basis, scope, acceptance time and status, with **Revoke**.
Record a new rights declaration	Adds a new declaration without deleting the old record.
Source posts	The post table with a per-post editorial decision.
Imports	File, kind, imported time, raw/accepted/excluded counts and SHA-256.
Schedules	The schedules attached to this channel.
Recent stories	The latest clustered stories, with section, importance and risk.

3.5 Import an authorised export

The import route is the verified way to bring in live content on this installation.

1. In **Import authorized content**, choose the **JSON export** file. The owner import format and Telegram Desktop JSON export are supported, with a maximum of 40 MB.
2. Optionally choose **Referenced media files** so captions and credits stay linked to the original message. Derivative images are reversible copies; originals remain in the data directory.
3. Choose **Import**.

Files are treated as untrusted data. Embedded instructions in a post never become policy. The import summary reports raw, accepted and excluded counts. Exclusion is normal: empty messages, forwarded copies, promotion-only posts, channel administration and similar items are left out with a recorded reason.

3.6 Decide a single post

Each source post has a state and, where relevant, a classification reason. Use **Why this classification** to read the explanation. Then choose one of:

- **Include in story processing**
- **Exclude from story processing**
- **Include as context only**
- **Mark as promotional**
- **Mark as channel administration**
- **Mark as profanity/abuse**

Choose **Apply decision**. An included post can later be withdrawn with one of **Rights withdrawn**, **Deleted at source**, **Duplicate** or **Promotion only**, followed by **WITHDRAW**. Withdrawal is recorded; it does not silently erase the audit trail.

3.7 Telegram connection

The source's Telegram page exposes the live connection controls:

- **Credentials**, **Signed in** and **Login stage**.
- **Channel handle**, with **Save handle**.
- **Test source connection**.
- **Phone number (international format)** and **Request login code**.
- **Submit code**, **Finish sign-in** and **Cancel login** when a login is in progress.
- The effective cutoff-to-cutoff window, **Committed watermark** and stored included posts.
- **Import last 30 days (context only)**.
- **Sync window**.
- **Window and retrieval history**.

On the tested installation the page reported **Missing** for the API id/hash and explained that live credentials were not configured. Live Telegram login and retrieval could not be verified for this documentation. The rights-cleared JSON import is the verified route. Never place a login code, two-step password or API hash in a chat, email or document.

---

4. Stories

A **story** is the cluster of source posts that belong together: the original report, updates, corrections, replies and album items. A story is not yet an article; it is the evidence bundle from which an article is drafted.

4.1 The story list

The list can be filtered by **Channel** and **Section**, then refreshed with **Filter**. Columns show the story headline, section, genre, risk, importance, status and last update. Importance is a decimal score; risk is `LOW` or `HIGH`.

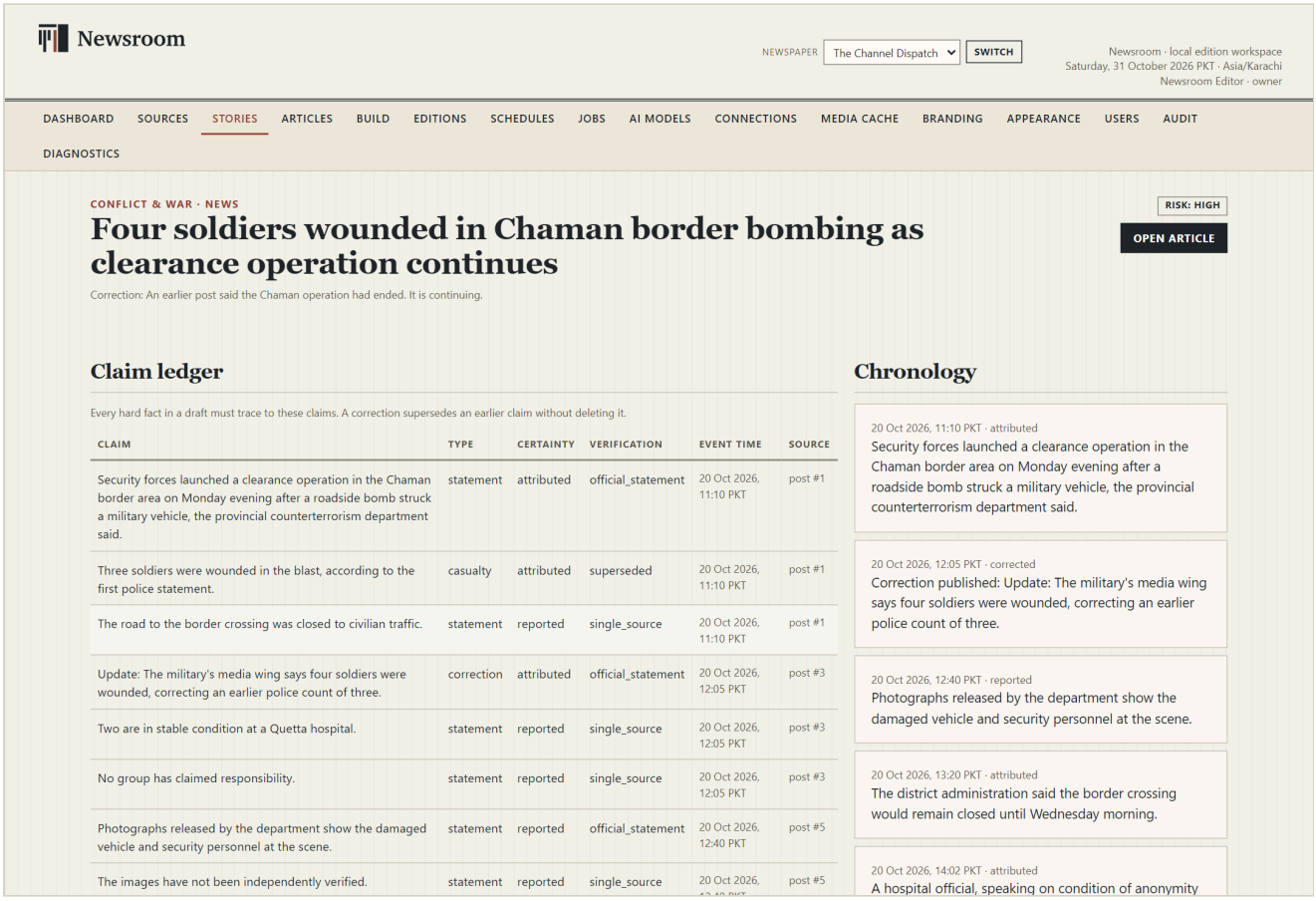


Figure 3. A story evidence record. The claim ledger, source fragments, research controls and chronology are on one page.

4.2 The evidence record

Open a story to see:

Panel	Meaning
Claim ledger	Every hard fact in the draft, with claim type, certainty, verification state, event time and source post. A correction supersedes an earlier claim without deleting it.
Source fragments	The original messages, with message number and local time.
Research context	**Search sources** and **Add URL**, plus the research policy in force. Candidates stay out of the paper until an editor accepts them.
Chronology	The sequence of attributed, reported and corrected events.

Panel	Meaning
Story state	Fingerprint, creation time, update time and originating channel.

The claim ledger is the most important panel. A claim marked `unverified`, `single_source` or `superseded` deserves a decision before the article is approved. An accepted research page is attributed context, not automatic verification.

4.3 Research context

The research control depends on the publication's **Automatic research** policy. On the tested build the story page showed **Search: Publisher RSS feeds · Ready · Policy: editor triggered**, with **Search sources** and **Add URL**. The page states that candidates stay out of the paper until an editor accepts them, and that accepted pages are attributed context rather than verification.

Automatic web research providers were not exercised for this documentation. Do not assume that a search provider is configured or that a result has been fact-checked by Newsroom.

---

5. Articles

Articles is the editorial list. Each article belongs to a story and can appear in one or more editions.

5.1 The article list

Filters:

- **Status** — **All statuses**, **Draft**, **Needs Review**, **Approved**, **Rejected**.
- **Channel** — **All accessible** or a named channel.
- **Search** — free text.
- **Filter** — applies the selection.

The table shows the article headline and deck, section, genre, status, risk, word count, revision and update time. Select a headline to open the editor.

5.2 The article editor

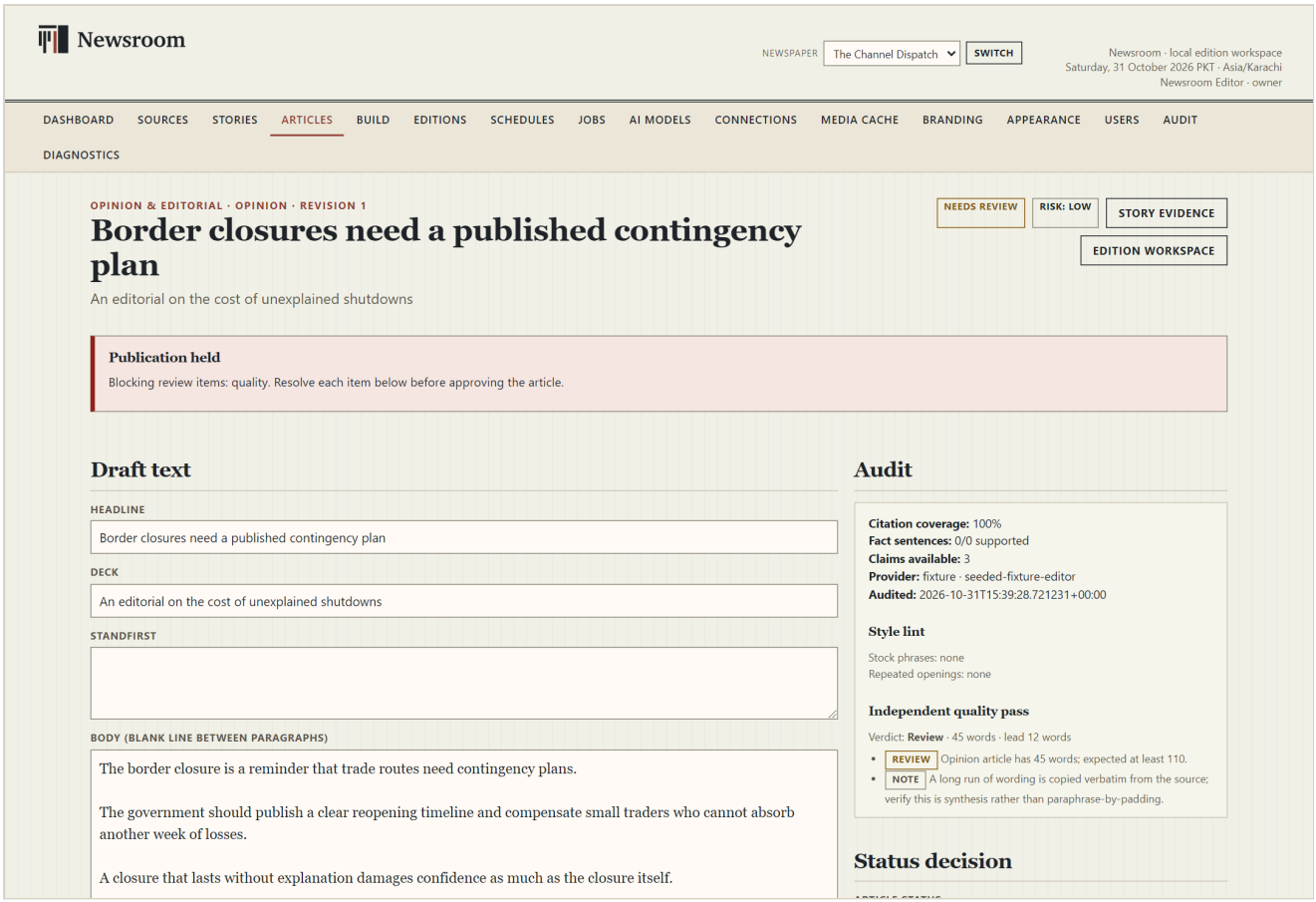


Figure 4. The article editor for a synthetic opinion article. Draft fields, audit results, review items and status controls are visible.

The editor is divided into a main column and a side column.

Main column

Field or control	Purpose
Headline	The printed headline. Keep it accurate and supported by the text.
Deck	The subheadline under the headline.
Standfirst	A short introductory paragraph where the layout uses one.
Body (blank line between paragraphs)	The article text. A blank line separates paragraphs.
Byline	Printed under the headline when the publication uses one.
Section	One of the configured sections: **National & Internal**, **Regional**, **International & Geopolitics**, **Defence & Security**, **Conflict & War**, **Analysis**, **Opinion & Editorial**, **Briefs**.
Genre	**News**, **Analysis**, **Opinion**, **Editor Note** or **Brief**.
Lock this headline and text against regeneration	Prevents a later drafting run from replacing your text.
Save revision	Saves a new revision and updates the preview state.
Undo unsaved changes	Reverts the form to the last saved revision.
Re-run independent audit	Runs the evidence and quality checks again against the current saved text.

Side column

Panel	Meaning
Versions	The revision history. Each entry records the time and the saved field values.
Sources used	The channel, post count and earliest post recorded when the article was drafted. A merged story credits every contributing channel. Later source changes do not rewrite this record.
Review items	Category, severity, message, status and decision, with **Approve item** and **Reject item**.
Audit	Citation coverage, fact sentences supported, claims available, provider and audit time.
Style lint	Stock phrases and repeated openings.
Independent quality pass	A verdict with word count and lead length, plus review notes.
Status decision	**Article status** with **Update status** and **Lock article**.
Media	The selected lead image or **No selected media.**
External context	Accepted references and their role.
Appears in	Editions and versions that include the article.

5.3 Article status

The status menu offers **Draft**, **Needs review**, **Needs research**, **Approved**, **Held** and **Excluded**. Choose the status that reflects the editorial decision, then **Update status**.

- **Approved** means the article is ready for a clean release. It does not mean the facts are proven; it means an editor accepted responsibility.
- **Held** keeps the article out of release while preserving the work.
- **Excluded** removes it from the edition. The record remains available.
- **Needs research** is appropriate when a claim is unresolved.

A **Publication held** notice appears at the top of an article when blocking review items remain. The notice names the blocking category. Resolve each item before approving.

5.4 Review items

For each open item:

1. Read the message and open the relevant evidence.
2. Choose **Approve item** when the item is acceptable, or **Reject item** when it is not.
3. Add a short decision note when the form asks for one.
4. Re-run the audit if you changed the text.

Approving a quality item does not edit the article. If the item is valid, improve the copy, save a revision, then rebuild the edition preview.

5.5 The audit panels

The audit is a deterministic check, not a truth oracle.

- **Citation coverage** reports the proportion of sentences that trace to source material.
- **Fact sentences** reports how many are supported.
- **Claims available** is the size of the claim ledger.
- **Style lint** flags repeated openings and stock phrases.
- **Independent quality pass** compares length and lead construction with the genre expectation. A short opinion piece or a brief can legitimately trigger a review.

A clean audit does not make a false sentence true. Read the source fragments and the claim ledger.

5.6 Media

The article editor shows the current lead media, its type and dimensions, a **Download original** link and fields for **Caption** and **Credit**. Use **Remove lead media from the layout** to drop it. Eligible source assets can be chosen as a replacement, with **Caption for replacement** and **Credit for replacement**. **Supporting media (optional)** can be promoted from a source asset.

The layout deliberately limits images: briefs and narrow columns do not receive a second picture. Captions and credits must match the source. Do not use an image merely because it is available.

5.7 Locks

Lock article and **Lock this headline and text against regeneration** protect approved work. A lock is an editorial signal as well as a technical one. Release the lock deliberately if the article must be regenerated.

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6. Build an edition

Build turns selected source posts into a new edition.

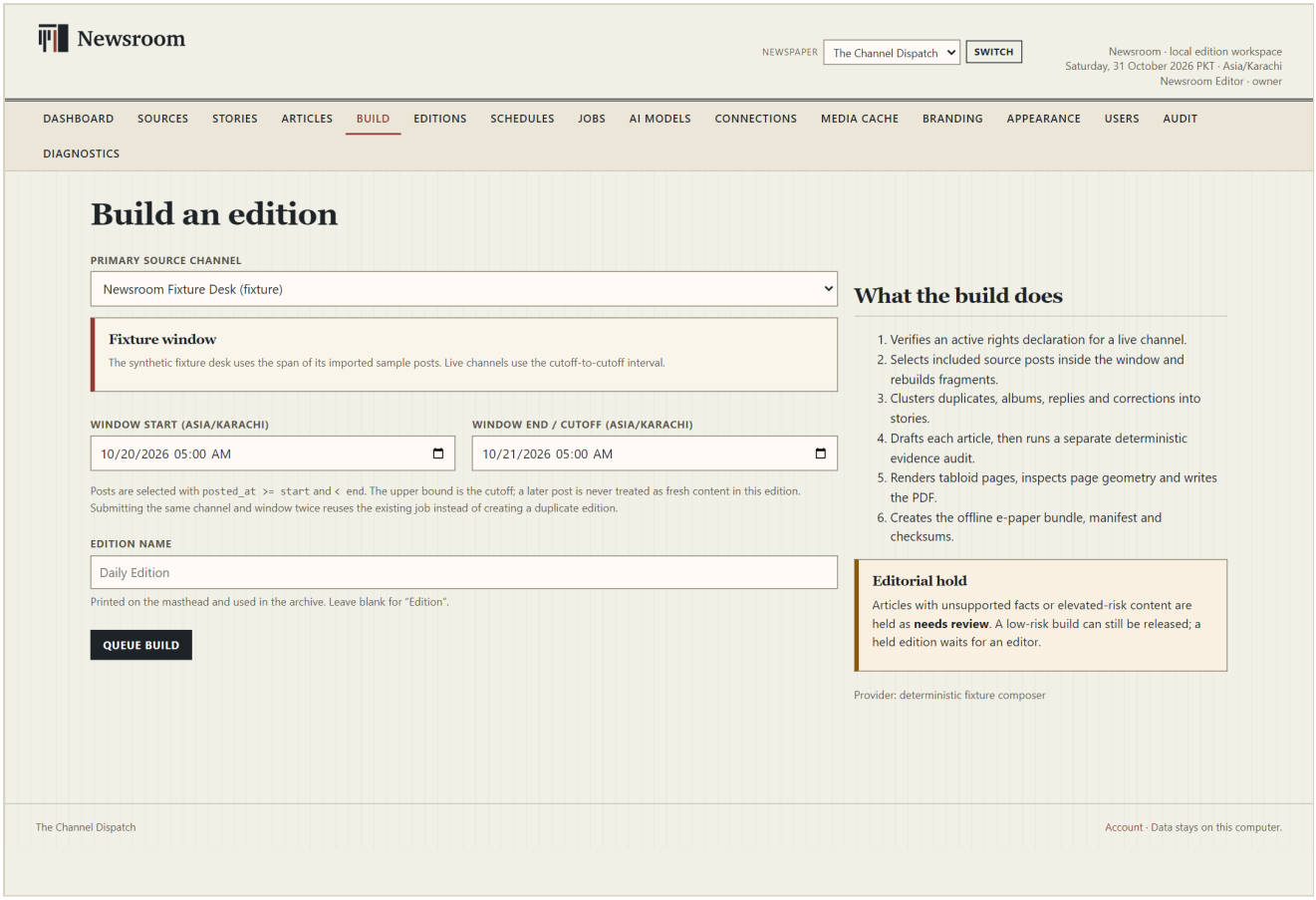


Figure 5. The Build page. The primary source, cutoff window, edition name and queue control are shown together.

6.1 Fields

Field	Meaning
Primary source channel	The channel for this build. Fixture channels are labelled `(fixture)`.
Window start (Asia/Karachi)	The first instant included.
Window end / cutoff (Asia/Karachi)	The upper bound. A post at exactly this instant belongs to the next issue.
Edition name	Printed on the masthead and used in the archive. Leave blank for **Edition**.
Queue build	Creates the job.

Posts are selected with `posted_at >= start` and `< end`. Submitting the same channel and window twice reuses the existing job instead of creating a duplicate edition.

For a fixture channel, the window is filled from the span of the imported sample posts. For a live channel, use the cutoff-to-cutoff interval.

6.2 What the build does

The page lists the stages:

1. Verifies an active rights declaration for a live channel.
2. Selects included source posts inside the window and rebuilds fragments.
3. Clusters duplicates, albums, replies and corrections into stories.
4. Drafts each article, then runs a separate deterministic evidence audit.
5. Renders tabloid pages, inspects page geometry and writes the PDF.
6. Creates the offline e-paper bundle, manifest and checksums.

The **Editorial hold** note explains that articles with unsupported facts or elevated-risk content are held as needing review. A low-risk build can still be released; a held edition waits for an editor.

6.3 After queueing

What you should see: a job page with a message such as **Build queued. Worker started in the background**. The job moves through its stages. A fixture build normally finishes in under a minute. A live build with media and a local model can take much longer.

A finished build normally ends in **Awaiting review**, not **Published**. Open **Editions** to review it.

---

7. Jobs

Jobs lists queued, running and finished work.

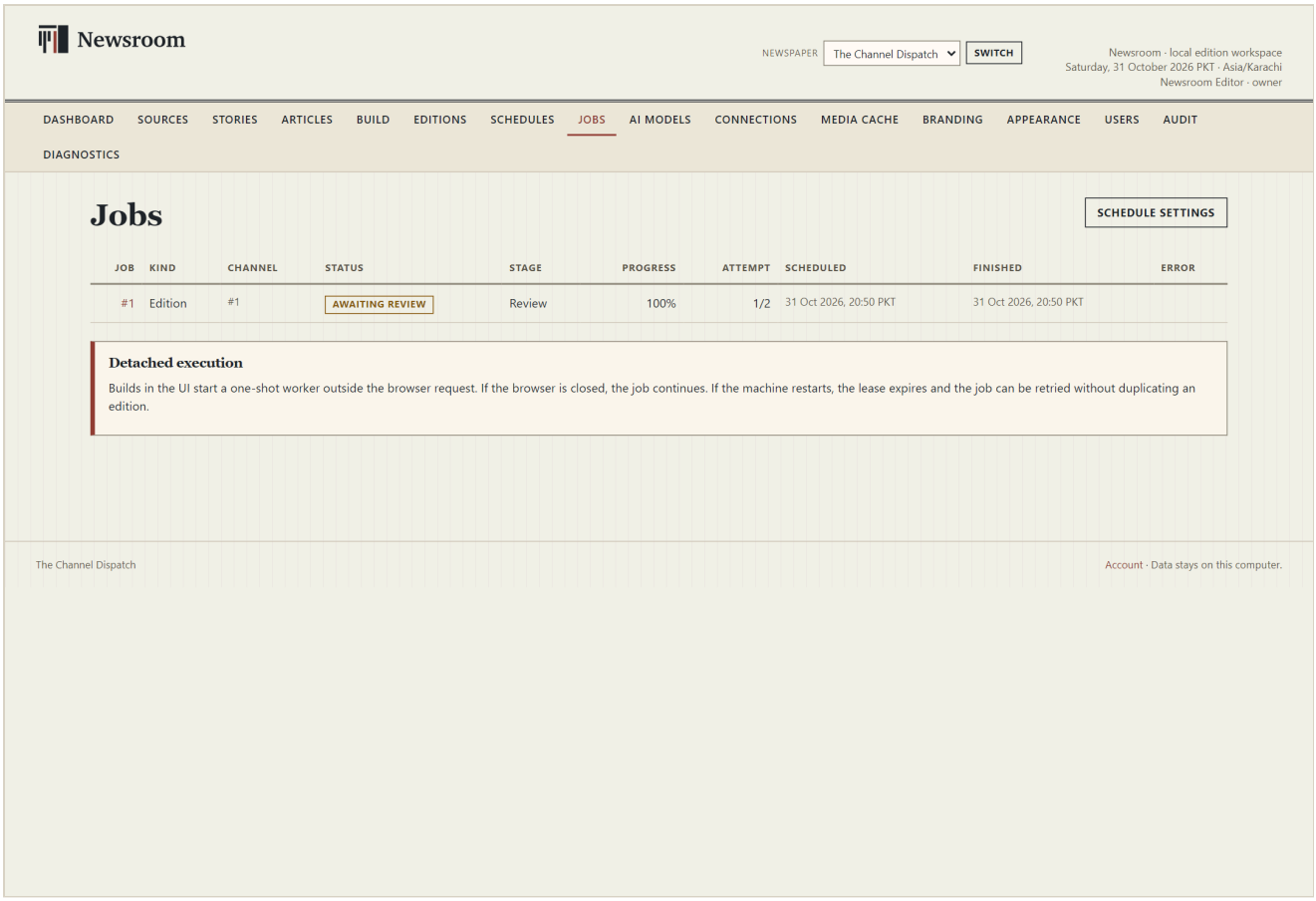


Figure 6. Jobs after a fixture build. The finished job is in Awaiting review; the edition was not released automatically.

7.1 The list

Columns: **Job**, **Kind**, **Channel**, **Status**, **Stage**, **Progress**, **Attempt**, **Scheduled**, **Finished**, **Error**. Select a job number to open its detail.

7.2 Job detail

The job page shows the status, attempt count, a progress bar, the current stage and percentage, the step list with per-step state, the result, actions and timing.

Common statuses include **Scheduled**, **Queued**, **Running**, **Awaiting review**, **Published**, **Failed**, **Paused** and **Cancelled**. The exact status set depends on the job; read the badge rather than assuming a sequence.

7.3 Actions

Action	When to use it
Retry failed job	After the cause of a failure is understood.
Continue from checkpoint	Resume a paused or interrupted job without discarding completed work.
Stop safely	Ask the worker to stop at a checkpoint.
Restart from beginning	Discard the current draft state and start the job again.
Cancel job	Abandon the job permanently. The source checkpoint is retained for a later manual build.

Cancel job cannot be undone. Use it only when you do not intend to finish that job.

7.4 Detached execution

Builds start a one-shot worker outside the browser request. If the window is hidden with **Continue in background**, the job continues. If the machine restarts, the lease expires and the job can be retried without duplicating an edition. The worker is still part of the local application; it is not a cloud service.

---

8. Editions

Editions is the archive of prepared and released issues.

8.1 The edition list

Column	Meaning
Edition	Name and number. Select it to open the workspace.
Date	The edition date in the publication time zone.
Mode	For example **Manual**.
Status	`PUBLISHED`, `AWAITING REVIEW` and other states.
Sources	**ALL SOURCES** or the contributing channels.
Pages	Page count.
Version	The published or working version number.
Released	Release time, when published.
Files	**PDF** and **E-paper** links.

8.2 The edition workspace

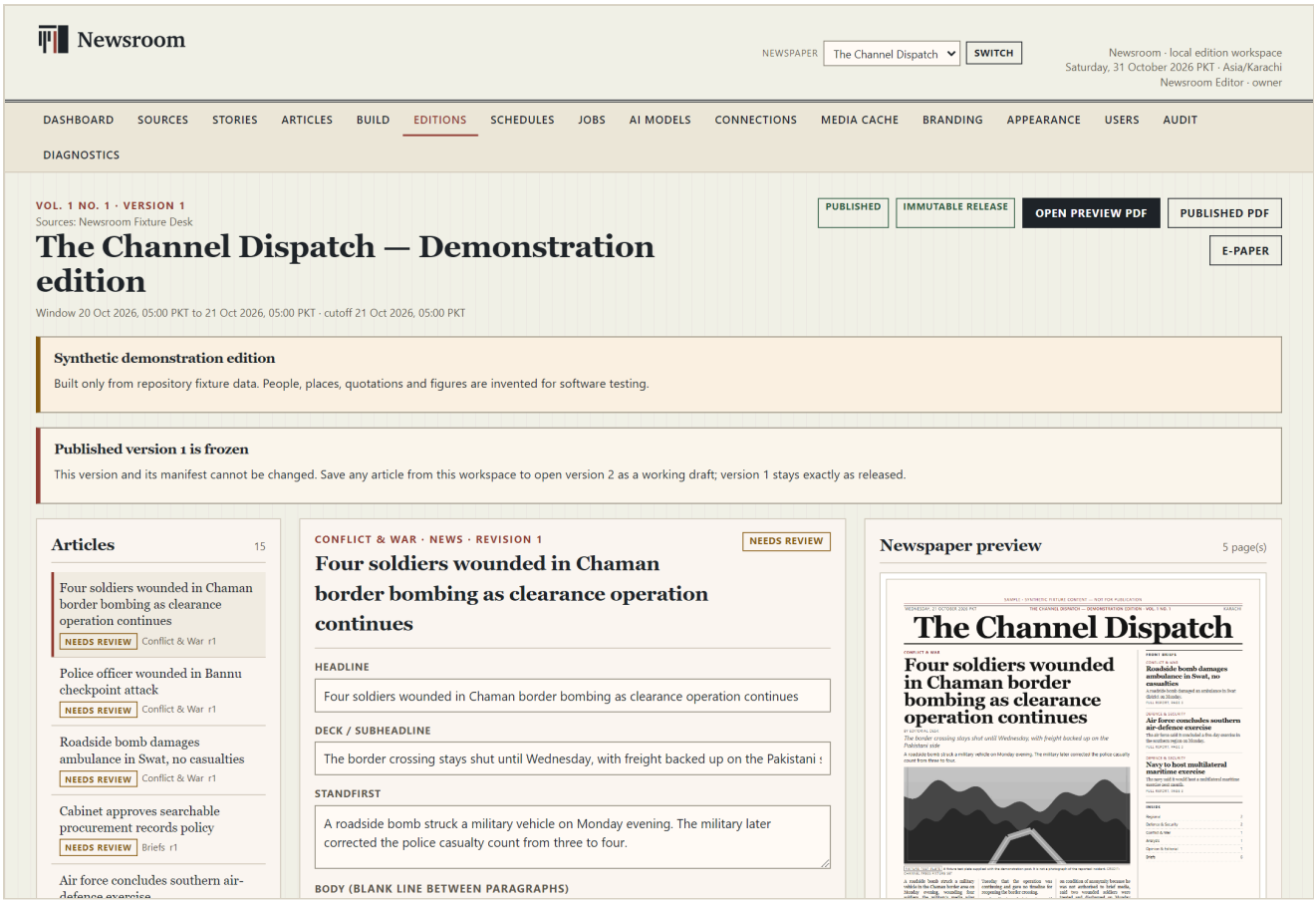


Figure 7. The edition workspace for a published edition. Articles, versions, release state, quality measurements and page preview share one screen.

The workspace has three columns:

- **Left:** the article list, the version family and the release controls.
- **Middle:** the selected article with its draft fields, media and review items.
- **Right:** the newspaper preview, page list and article panels.

The header shows the volume and issue number, the source channels, the window and cutoff, the status badge and the output buttons. For a published edition the badge reads **Immutable release**.

8.3 Output buttons

Button	What it opens
Open preview PDF	The working preview PDF, when one exists.
Published PDF	The frozen PDF of the released version.
E-paper	The offline page-turner and text edition.

Published PDF and **E-paper** appear for a released edition. **Open preview PDF** appears when a working preview exists. If a button is missing, the corresponding file has not been produced.

8.4 Release held

Before release, the workspace shows a **Release held** panel naming every blocking item. The release button stays disabled until the blockers are resolved.

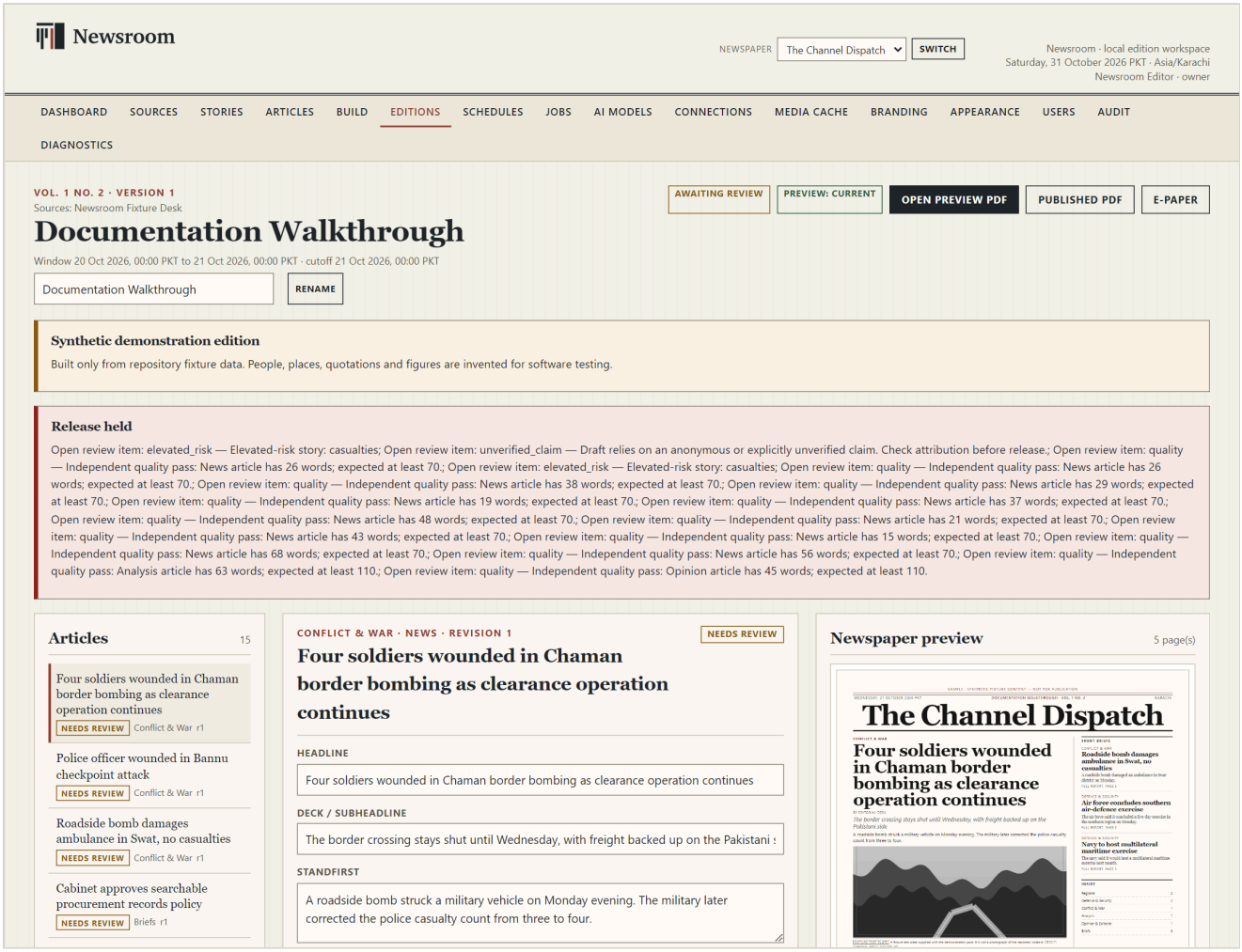


Figure 8. A held edition. The preview and PDF exist, but release is blocked by quality and risk items.

Typical blockers:

- a story with elevated risk;
- an anonymous or unverified claim;
- an independent quality pass that finds the article shorter than its genre expects;
- a preview that no longer represents the saved text.

Resolve blockers in the article's **Review items** and **Status decision** panels, then rebuild the preview if the copy changed.

8.5 Preview state

The header reports **Preview: current**, **Preview: stale** or another state. A stale preview means saved editorial changes are not in the rendered pages. The page offers **Rebuild preview now** or **Rebuild preview only**. Do not release a stale preview.

8.6 Release a version

1. Confirm that every blocker is resolved.
2. Choose **Release version N**.

What you should see: the status becomes **Published**, an **Immutable release** badge appears, and the output buttons become available. The edition and its manifest can no longer be changed. There is no automatic upload.

8.7 Versions and corrections

A published version is frozen. To correct it, choose **Open working version N+1**. That creates a draft from the latest saved revisions while version N stays exactly as released. Edit, review, rebuild the preview and release the new version.

The **Versions** panel lists each version with its status, a short SHA and the release time. Select a version to inspect it. The old version remains in the archive as the audit trail.

8.8 Edition quality

The **Edition quality** panel reports:

- **Pages**
- **Warnings**
- **Page fill:** average and lowest percentage
- **Underfull pages**, with the note **(reported, not a proof failure)**
- **PDF bytes**
- **PDF SHA**

Underfull pages are a layout observation. They are worth inspecting, especially in a thin edition, but they do not by themselves block release.

8.9 Editing inside the workspace

The middle column repeats the article fields and adds media controls. Changes use **Save and update preview** or **Save revision**. The workspace also shows **Source evidence**, **Claims**, **Chronology**, **Revision history** and, for a released version, **Published snapshot**.

If the published snapshot and the current content hash differ, the workspace marks the article as changed. Saving from a published workspace opens the working version described above.

8.10 Provenance

The **Provenance** panel states the source basis and the edition folder on disk. For a fixture edition it also states that only synthetic fixture data was used. Do not rename or edit files in a published edition folder; that would break its checksums.

9. Schedules

Schedules defines when a cutoff occurs and when a reviewed edition may be released. The two times are separate.

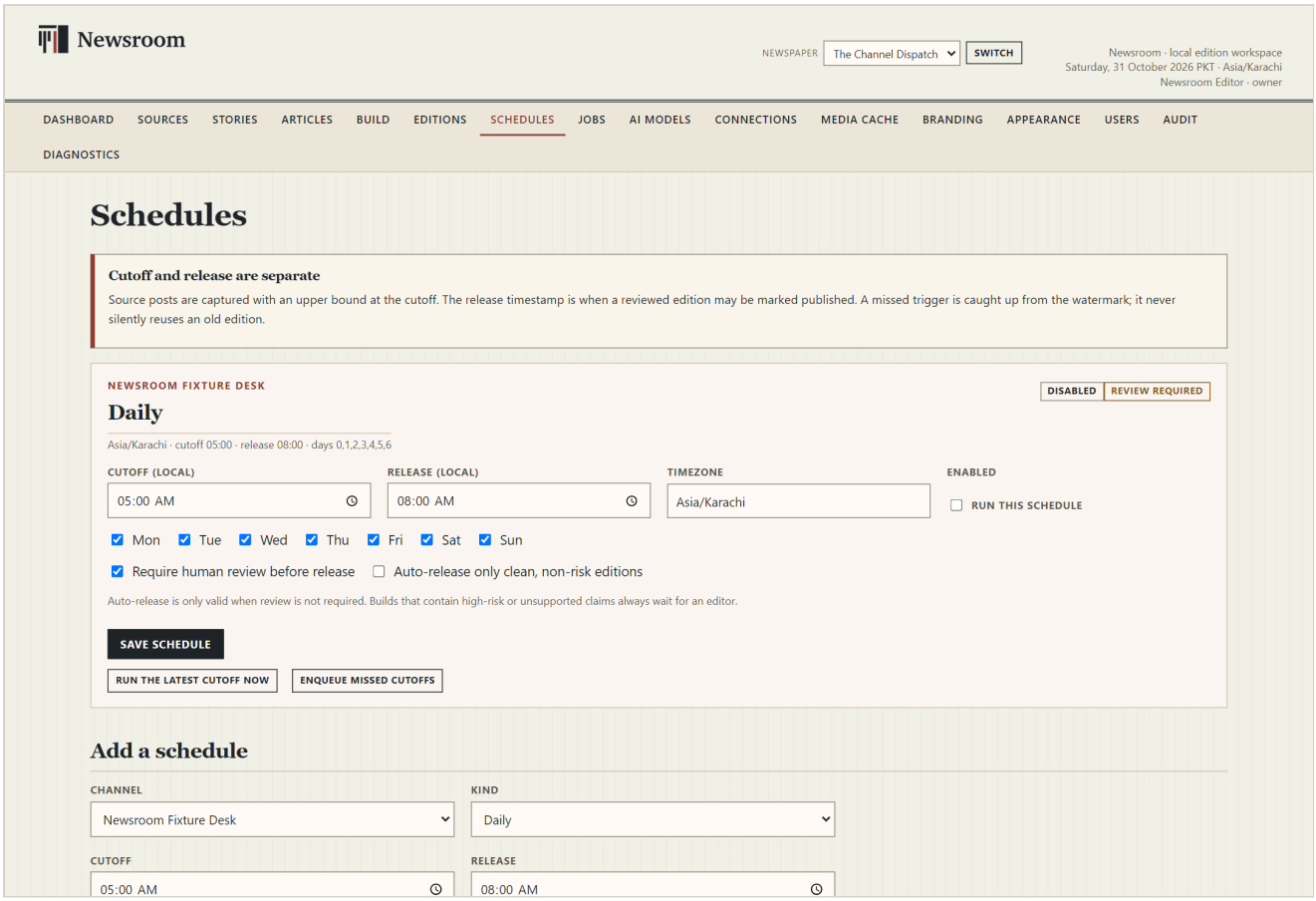


Figure 9. The Schedules page. A schedule can be enabled, run now or used to enqueue missed cutoffs.

9.1 The schedule card

Field or control	Meaning
Kind badge	**Daily**, **Weekly roundup** or **Monthly roundup**.
Cutoff (local)	The upper bound for source posts.
Release (local)	The time from which a reviewed edition may be marked published.
Timezone	The IANA zone used for both times.
Enabled	Turns the schedule on. New schedules start disabled.
Days	Monday to Sunday checkboxes.
Require human review before release	Keeps release manual. This is the safe default.
Auto-release only clean, non-risk editions	Allows automatic release only when review is not required and no high-risk or unsupported claim is present.
Save schedule	Saves the settings.
Run the latest cutoff now	Runs the most recent cutoff immediately.
Enqueue missed cutoffs	Queues cutoffs that were missed while the application was not running.

A missed trigger is caught up from the watermark; it never silently reuses an old edition. Builds with high-risk or unsupported claims always wait for an editor.

9.2 Add a schedule

Choose the channel, the kind, the cutoff, the release time and the timezone, then **Create schedule**. New schedules start disabled and in review-required mode. Enable the schedule deliberately after checking the times.

9.3 What is not automatic

The installer does not create a Windows scheduled task. On the tested installation, a schedule is useful for defining the cutoff and release policy and for running or catching up manually. Automatic unattended builds while the application is closed were not verified and should not be promised to readers or staff.

---

10. AI Models

AI Models manages optional local Qwen3.5 models. No source content is sent to an online model.

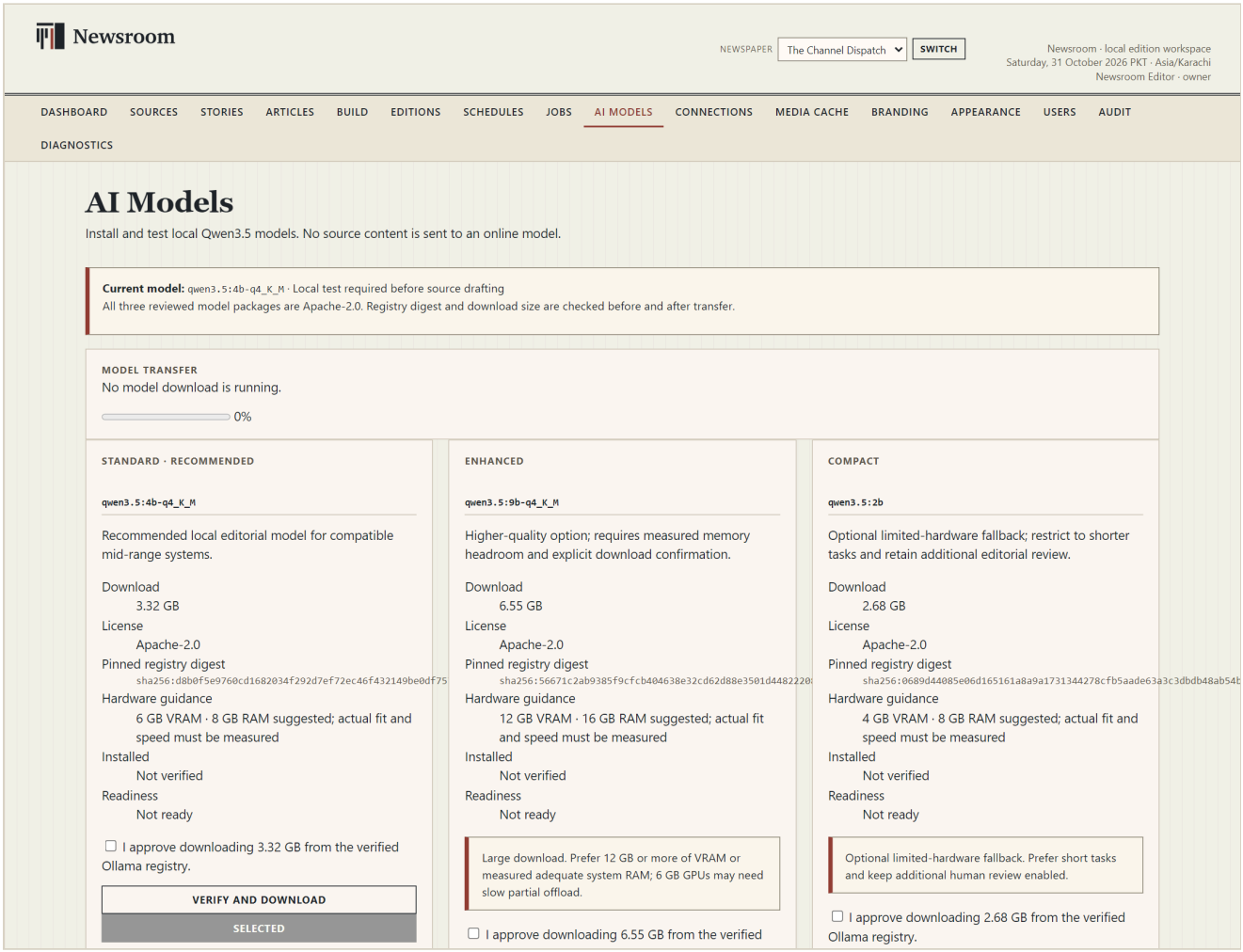


Figure 10. The AI Models page. The three reviewed profiles are local downloads with pinned digests and hardware guidance.

10.1 Profiles

Profile	Model	Download	Suggested hardware
Standard · Recommended	`qwen3.5:4b-q4_K_M`	3.32 GB	6 GB VRAM · 8 GB RAM
Enhanced	`qwen3.5:9b-q4_K_M`	6.55 GB	12 GB VRAM · 16 GB RAM
Compact	`qwen3.5:2b`	2.68 GB	4 GB VRAM · 8 GB RAM

All three reviewed packages are Apache-2.0. The registry digest and download size are checked before and after transfer. Hardware guidance is a suggestion; actual fit and speed must be measured on the machine.

10.2 Readiness states

Each card reports **Installed** and **Readiness**. A model can be installed but **Not verified** and **Not ready** until its local test passes. The **Current model** line names the selected profile and repeats that a local test is required before source drafting.

10.3 Install and select

1. Tick **I approve downloading … from the verified Ollama registry** on the chosen card.
2. Choose **Verify and download**.
3. Watch **Model transfer**. A running transfer can be cancelled with **Cancel transfer**.
4. When the profile is installed, choose **Select profile**.
5. Choose **Test local model** and wait for the result.

Success check: the selected profile shows as current and its readiness reports that the local test passed. Until then, drafting for a real channel is not considered ready.

10.4 Limits

- Newsroom does not install Ollama or download model weights by itself. The local Ollama service must be installed and running.
- Models are large. They consume disk space outside the Newsroom data folder.
- A 9B model may be slow or may not fit on a 6 GB GPU. **Compact** is a reduced-capability fallback, not an automatic replacement.
- AI drafts require editorial review. The independent audit cannot prove that a sentence is true.
- On the tested installation the models were not downloaded, so model inference, download resumption and the draft test were not verified end to end.

---

11. Branding

Branding & edition policy controls the publication identity and the rules used by the layout.

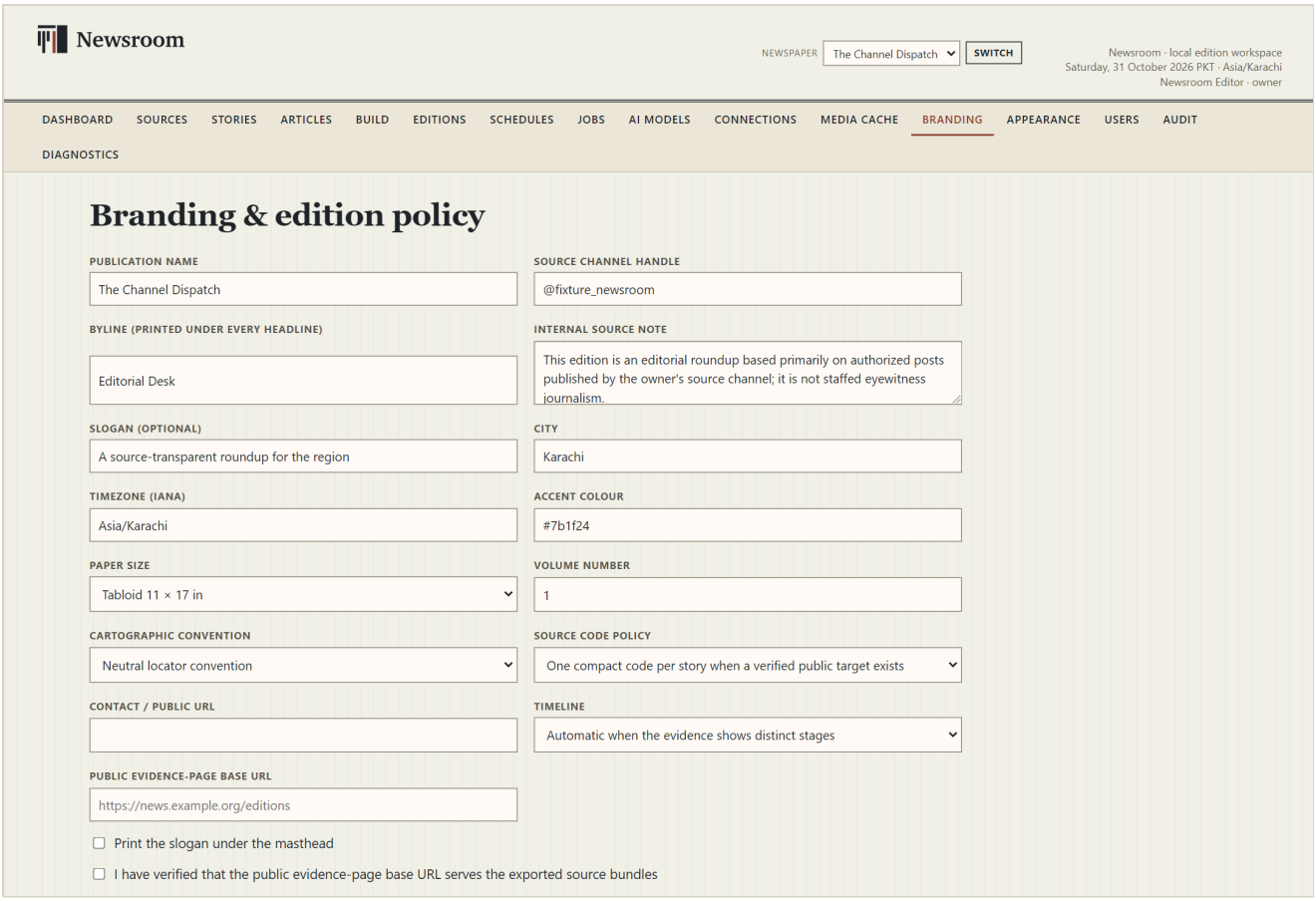


Figure 11. Branding & edition policy. Identity, paper size, source-code policy, research policy and section order are configured here.

11.1 Publication profile

Field	Meaning
Publication name	The masthead name of the newspaper.
Source channel handle	The handle shown in source notes.
Byline (printed under every headline)	The default byline.
Internal source note	A local note about the source basis.
Slogan (optional)	Printed only when **Print the slogan under the masthead** is ticked.
City	The publication city.
Timezone (IANA)	For example `Asia/Karachi`.
Accent colour	The publication accent.
Paper size	**Tabloid 11 × 17 in** or **A3 297 × 420 mm**.
Volume number	The printed volume.
Cartographic convention	**Neutral locator convention**, **Pakistan publication convention** or **Egypt publication convention**.
Source code policy	**One compact code per story when a verified public target exists**, **Verified public target only** or **No printed codes**.
Contact / public URL	The public contact address.

Field	Meaning
Timeline	**Automatic when the evidence shows distinct stages**, **Always when source times exist** or **Off**.
Public evidence-page base URL	Used only when you genuinely publish evidence pages.
Print the slogan under the masthead	Controls the slogan.
I have verified that the public evidence-page base URL serves the exported source bundles	A deliberate confirmation. Tick it only after checking the URL.
Save publication profile	Saves the profile.

11.2 Automatic research

The **Research policy** can be **Off**, **Editor-triggered only**, **Automatic for substantial news** or **Automatic for all eligible stories**. The **Search provider** can be **Automatic (configured API, then publisher feeds)**, **Google Programmable Search**, **Brave Search API**, **GDELT DOC 2.0** or **Publisher RSS feeds**. **Queries per story** and **Candidate cap per story** limit the work. **Acceptance** can be **Every candidate waits for an editor** or **Accept ordinary dated context; hold contested or high-risk claims**.

Automatic providers were not exercised in this documentation. Keep the policy conservative unless you can test the provider and review its output.

11.3 Section order

The order list controls the sequence of sections in the paper. Sections without articles are omitted, and the front page is always first. Use the move controls to reorder. The option **Allow closing light only when a documented true source is available** is a policy guard for the closing item.

11.4 Newspapers on this computer

The table lists each newspaper with its slug, timezone, status and an **Open** link, plus **Deactivate** where available. **New newspaper** creates a separate publication with its own sources, schedules, drafts, editions and archive. Creating a newspaper does not copy content from another one.

11.5 Sources for this newspaper

A source can be enabled or disabled for the current newspaper. **Priority 1** is used first; **Weight** scales story prominence. Disabling a source keeps its archive and Telegram access but excludes it from the next build. **Save** applies the setting; **Remove** detaches the source from this newspaper.

11.6 Editors for this newspaper

Publication editors can work on this newspaper without access to another paper. Telegram rights and channel ownership remain separate grants. This table shows the person, newspaper role and global role.

11.7 Map conventions

The map convention panel names the dataset, licence and disputed-boundary rule. The neutral convention draws disputed areas with a neutral dashed outline and does not adjudicate sovereignty. The Pakistan and Egypt conventions apply the publication’s cartographic convention and include a disclosure note. Choose

the convention deliberately; it is an editorial decision.

12. Appearance

Appearance controls the printed design. The page separates colours, fonts, type metrics, section accents, a print proof and revision history.

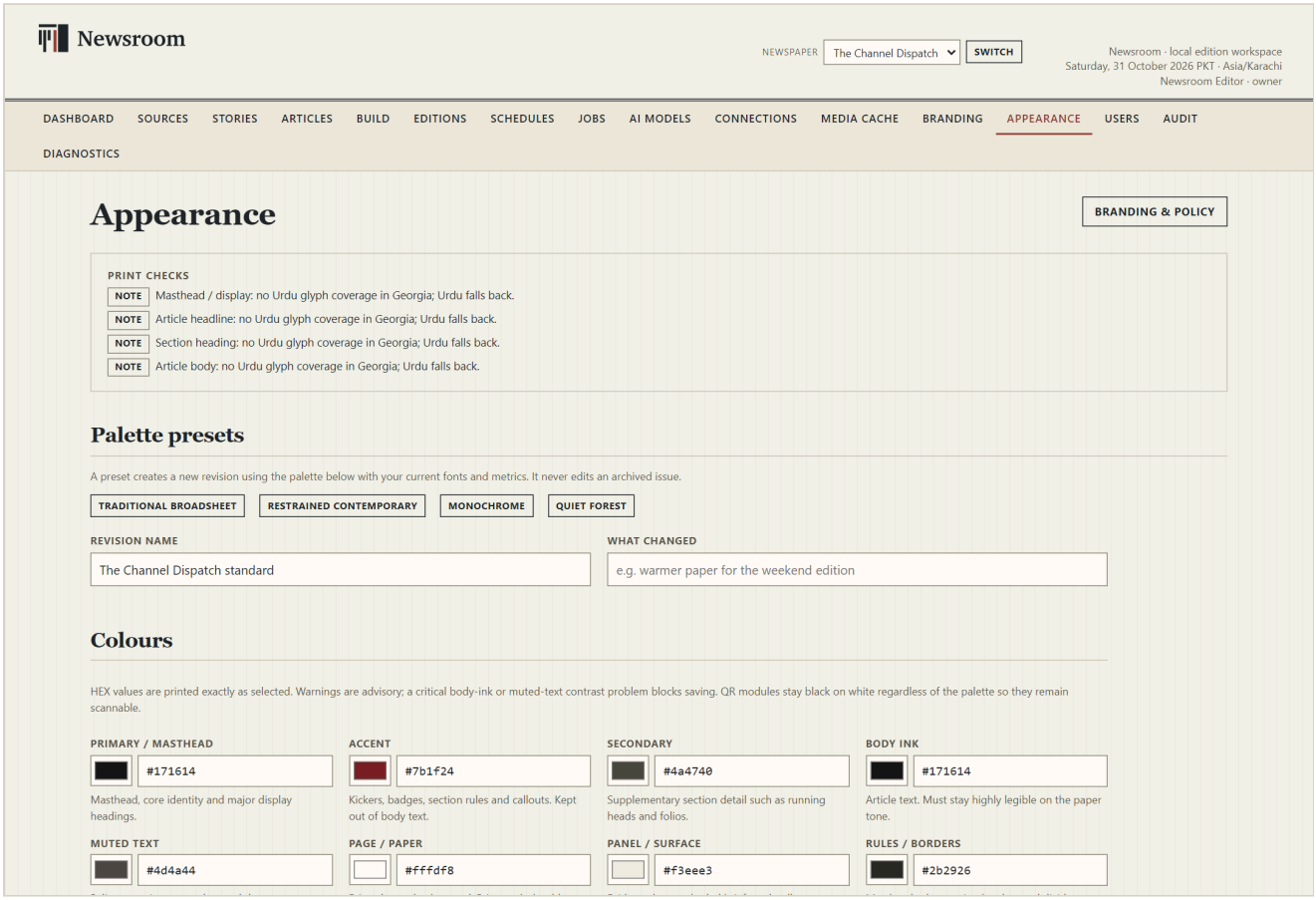


Figure 12. Appearance. Palette presets, print checks, colours and font roles are edited as a new theme revision.

12.1 Print checks

The top of the page reports font coverage. For example, it can warn that a masthead or body font has no Urdu glyph coverage and that Urdu will fall back. Read these notes before approving a theme for a multilingual paper. A fallback may be acceptable, but it should be a decision rather than a surprise.

12.2 Palette presets

Traditional broadsheet, **Restrained contemporary**, **Monochrome** and **Quiet forest** create a new revision using the palette with the current fonts and metrics. A preset never edits an archived issue.

12.3 Colours

Each colour has a labelled role:

Role	Used for
Primary / masthead	Masthead, core identity and major display headings.
Accent	Kickers, badges, section rules and callouts; kept out of body text.
Secondary	Running heads and folios.
Body ink	Article text; must stay highly legible on the paper tone.
Muted text	Bylines, captions, metadata and dates.
Page / paper	Printed page background; should stay light for print.
Panel / surface	Evidence boxes, shaded briefs and pull-quote panels.
Rules / borders	Masthead rules, section borders and dividers.
Link / QR labels	Printed citation labels and digital link text.

HEX values are printed exactly as selected. Warnings are advisory, but a critical body-ink or muted-text contrast problem blocks saving. QR modules stay black on white regardless of the palette so they remain scannable.

12.4 Fonts

Only families installed on the computer or imported into the local font library are listed. A missing weight or italic face is substituted and reported instead of being faked. For each role — **Masthead / display**, **Article headline**, **Section heading**, **Article body** and the other listed roles — choose a family, weight and style.

Imported files are embedded in the PDF, the proof and the e-paper. Upload only fonts you are licensed to embed.

12.5 Type metrics

Field	Allowed range
Body size (pt)	8.5 to 11.5
Body leading	1.2 to 1.62
Headline scale	0.85 to 1.18
Headline tracking (em)	-0.04 to 0.02
Masthead scale	0.78 to 1.12

The limits exist because the print layout has a minimum legibility standard. Do not force a fit by going below the allowed body size.

12.6 Section accents

A section accent colours that section’s kicker and genre labels without changing body ink. Each configured section can have its own accent.

12.7 Save, proof and reset

- **Save as new theme revision** creates the next immutable revision.

- **Render print proof** renders a specimen page from the current form values with the same stylesheet and font files as the edition. It is a specimen, not a news report. Inspect it at 100% zoom.
- **Reset colours, fonts and metrics to the standard theme** returns the form to the standard values.

12.8 Imported font library

The table lists family, face, file, size and licence note. To import, choose a **Font file (.ttf, .otf, .ttc)**, enter a **Licence note**, tick **I am licensed to use and embed this font**, then choose **Import font**. Files are validated with fontTools and stored under a checksum. A font referenced by a saved theme revision cannot be deleted, because that would make an archived design unreproducible.

Font import and print-proof rendering were not exercised end to end for this documentation.

12.9 Revision history

Revisions are immutable. Saving another theme creates the next revision; nothing rewrites an edition that is already published. The table shows the revision, name, creation time, status and notes.

---

13. Connections and Diagnostics

13.1 Connections

Connections runs read-only checks. On the tested build the rows were:

Service	Example result
Internet access	READY — an HTTPS connection succeeded.
Database	READY — `channel_press.db` readable (WAL SQLite).
Free disk space	READY — free space in the data volume against a quota target.
Windows desktop runtime	READY — WebView2 Runtime installed.
Print browser	READY — the bundled Chromium path.
FFmpeg (optional)	NEEDS ATTENTION — not installed; video stills use the OpenCV fallback.
OpenCV (video stills)	READY.
Paged.js renderer	READY.
PDF inspection	READY — PyMuPDF available for geometry QA.
Font inspection	READY — fontTools available.
Telegram live adapter	UNAVAILABLE — API id/hash not configured.
Local model	NEEDS ATTENTION — installed model still needs its local draft test.
Public source list (optional)	NEEDS ATTENTION — not configured; printed QRs stay in truthful source appendix mode.

Choose **Check again** to refresh. The page also shows the Telegram source status and the local AI status, with links to **Open source connection**, **Import rights-cleared posts** and **Open AI models**.

A NEEDS ATTENTION row is not always a fault. FFmpeg is optional; the public source list is optional; an unconfigured Telegram adapter is expected on an import-only installation.

13.2 Diagnostics

Diagnostics repeats the counts and component table with a next action for each row, and adds a **Configuration** table:

- the environment file path;
- the Telegram session file path;
- whether the Telegram API id/hash is present;
- whether a Telegram session exists;
- the Ollama endpoint, for example `http://127.0.0.1:11434`;
- the local model and its test state;
- pending jobs.

The **Data and privacy** note explains that the database, media derivatives and published bundles stay under the local data and output folders. Credentials are optional, stored outside Git and never rendered into print output or manifests. The Telegram session file behaves like a password.

The page also contains a legacy maintenance note that names an old command-line backup tool. This manual does not use it. Use the GUI copy method in **Installation & Maintenance** instead.

13.3 About Newsroom

The About panel states:

> Newsroom is a local workspace for preparing and reviewing newspaper editions from authorized sources.

It also states that the publication name, masthead, themes and released editions remain independently controlled.

---

14. Media cache

Media cache shows what can be deleted and what is protected.

Control	Meaning
Safe-to-delete cache (dry run)	The count and size of files that are not referenced by protected work.
Clear unused media cache (safest)	Deletes only the safe set.
Clear all deletable media (including derivatives)	Deletes the wider deletable set, including derivatives.
Never deleted by these controls	The protection list.

The protection list includes media referenced by an active or awaiting-review edition, media under an editor lock, provenance and rights records, source post records and files whose deletion status is uncertain. Working media of a published edition is removed automatically after a successful publication; failed or unreviewed editions keep theirs for recovery.

The page also prints a legacy command-line equivalent. Ignore it for ordinary use. Media cache deletion was not exercised for this documentation; treat both clear buttons as destructive and back up the data folder first.

---

15. Users and account controls

15.1 Users

The **Users** table shows the user, role, status, last sign-in, creation time, a role-change control and access actions.

- **Save** applies a role change.
- **Disable** suspends the account.
- **Reset password** issues a new password.
- **Create a user** asks for **Username**, **Display name**, **Role** and **Temporary password**. The user must change the password after first sign-in. Passwords are hashed with Argon2id; plaintext is never stored.

Roles are **Viewer**, **Operator**, **Editor** and **Owner**. Create the minimum number of accounts needed. A shared owner account weakens the audit trail.

15.2 Account

The account page shows your display name, role, join date and the **Change password** form. Enter the **Current password**, **New password** and **Confirm new password**, then **Update password**.

Sessions expire after 12 hours by default. **Sign out** revokes the session on the server; clearing a browser cookie alone is not treated as a sign-out. Always sign out on a shared Windows account.

---

16. Audit

Audit shows the local trail: time, actor, action, object and detail. Typical entries include `Auth.Login`, `Source.Import`, `Edition.Media Cleanup` and `User.Create Owner`.

The detail column is machine-oriented JSON. The trail is evidence that an action happened, not a substitute for editorial notes. Use the exact time and action when reporting a problem.

---

17. Keyboard, window and session behaviour

- Only one Newsroom window runs at a time. Launching again focuses the existing window, including one hidden with **Continue in background**.
- Closing with the X offers **Continue in background**, **Pause safely and exit** and **Keep open**.
- **Pause safely and exit** waits for the worker and model operations to reach safe checkpoints. It can take time.
- The window is designed for a minimum of 1024 × 700; the default is 1440 × 940.
- No application-specific keyboard shortcuts were verified for this manual. Use the visible controls.

---

18. Where the working files are

Item	Default location
Program files	`%LOCALAPPDATA%\Programs\Newsroom`
Data	`%LOCALAPPDATA%\ChannelPress`
Published editions	`%LOCALAPPDATA%\ChannelPress\output`
Logs	`%LOCALAPPDATA%\ChannelPress\logs`

`%LOCALAPPDATA%` is usually `C:\Users\<your Windows user>\AppData\Local`. The edition workspace's **Provenance** panel shows the exact folder for a released edition. Do not edit files inside a published edition folder.

---

19. Quick control reference

I want to…	Go to…
Check whether the installation is healthy	**Connections** or **Dashboard** → **Check connections**
Add a channel and record rights	**Sources** → **Register an authorized channel**
Import an authorised export	**Sources** → **Open channel** → **Import authorized content**
Fix a wrong post classification	**Sources** → **Open channel** → **Source posts** → **Apply decision**
Inspect evidence for a story	**Stories** → **Open story**
Edit copy and review claims	**Articles** → **Open article**
Approve or reject a review item	Article → **Review items**
Change an article's status	Article → **Status decision** → **Update status**
Queue a new edition	**Build** → **Queue build**
Watch or recover a build	**Jobs** → **Open job**
Release an edition	**Editions** → **Open edition** → **Release version N**
Correct a published edition	**Editions** → **Open edition** → **Open working version N+1**

I want to…	Go to…
Find the PDF or e-paper	**Editions → PDF / E-paper**
Change the masthead or paper size	**Branding**
Change colours, fonts or type size	**Appearance**
Set a cutoff and release time	**Schedules**
Install or test a local model	**AI Models**
Add a colleague	**Users → Create a user**
See who did what	**Audit**
Free disk space safely	**Media cache** (back up first)

---

20. Related manuals

- **Quick Start** — install, first run and a first edition.
- **Editorial & Publishing Guide** — the editorial lifecycle, evidence, review, release and corrections.
- **Installation & Maintenance** — installation, updates, backup, restore, uninstall and privacy.
- **Troubleshooting & FAQ** — symptoms, causes and safe recovery.
- **Documentation Index** — the full document map.

NEWSROOM · DOCUMENT 03

Editorial & Publishing Guide

Review, release and correct an edition

Product: Newsroom 1.0.0 for Windows
Audience: Editors and publishers who decide what runs, what is held and what is released
Last verified against: the packaged build of 31 October 2026 and a released synthetic edition

This guide is about editorial judgement and the release process, not about every control. Use the **User Manual** for a control reference. All examples in this guide come from synthetic demonstration data and are labelled as such.

> **The central rule:** a draft is not an edition, an edition is not published until it is released, and a released edition is frozen. Keep those three states separate in your own mind and in anything you tell readers.

1. The publishing lifecycle at a glance

```
Authorised source
      ↓
Stored posts → post classification → story cluster
      ↓
Draft article → evidence audit → human edit and review
      ↓
Edition layout → preview PDF and e-paper bundle
      ↓
Release version N → frozen edition, immutable manifest
      ↓
Correction? → working version N+1 → review → release N+1
```

Each arrow is a decision point, not an automatic guarantee. Newsroom can cluster, draft and render; it cannot decide whether a story is fair, lawful or safe to publish.

1.1 Three different objects

Object	What it means	What it is not
Source post	A message stored from an authorised channel or import.	A verified fact, or a licence to republish.
Story	A cluster of related posts with a claim ledger, chronology and research context.	A finished article.
Article	A drafted, editable piece with a headline, body, evidence and review state.	A published edition.

Object	What it means	What it is not
Edition	A laid-out issue with pages, a PDF and an e-paper bundle.	Published until a person releases it.
Published version	A frozen release with an immutable manifest and checksums.	A file you may edit in place.

The application uses these words consistently. Use them consistently when you brief staff, because "published" in conversation often means "finished", while in Newsroom it means "frozen and released".

---

2. Before the first issue: decide the publication's rules

These decisions belong to the owner or publisher, not the layout engine. Record them before a real issue, because changing them mid-cycle creates inconsistent editions.

2.1 Identity and ownership

- What is the publication's legal name and masthead?
- Who is the named editor or publisher?
- Which city and timezone govern the cutoff?
- What byline appears under every headline?
- What contact address is printed?

Set these on **Branding**. Each newspaper keeps its own identity. Do not place the Newsroom name or logo in your masthead; Newsroom identifies the software, not your publication.

2.2 Rights and source scope

- Which channels may you republish, and on what written authority?
- Who granted the rights, and where is the evidence filed?
- Does the grant cover text, images, video stills and translation?
- What happens when a source withdraws a post or a grant?

Register each channel on **Sources** with a grantor, authority basis and evidence reference. A rights declaration is not paperwork: it is the condition that allows a live build. Revocation blocks new imports, AI processing and builds for that channel.

2.3 What does not become news

A channel is a stream of messages, not a news list. Newsroom excludes many items automatically, but an editor still decides the borderline cases. Do not turn the following into stories without a clear public-interest reason:

- greetings, blessings and holiday messages;
- subscription and membership promotions;
- channel cross-promotion and "join our other channel" posts;
- advertising, price lists and sponsored content;

- forwarded copies of other outlets' reporting;
- empty posts, single emoji, broken links and test messages;
- administrative notices about the channel itself;
- graphic imagery or unverified casualty claims;
- content that identifies a private person without a public-interest justification.

Newsroom's post states include **Promotion / channel call**, **Duplicate or forwarded copy**, **No content** and similar reasons. Use **Why this classification** before overriding one. If you include a promotional or administrative post deliberately, record why in the article or an editorial note.

2.4 Risk appetite

A high-risk story is not automatically unpublishable, and a low-risk story is not automatically safe. Define who may approve:

- casualty numbers and named victims;
- allegations against identifiable people or organisations;
- active security operations;
- medical or legal claims;
- anonymous sourcing;
- material that could inflame a communal or regional dispute.

The **Risk** column is a prompt for human judgement. It is not a legal review.

---

3. From source post to story

3.1 Collection and import

The verified route on this installation is the rights-cleared JSON import. The Telegram connection screens exist, but the tested installation had no API credentials, so live login and retrieval were not verified. Do not build an editorial process that depends on live Telegram until you have tested it on your own installation.

When you import:

1. Keep the original export file. The import records a SHA-256 and the raw, accepted and excluded counts.
2. Include referenced media where captions and credits matter.
3. Read the exclusion summary. Four exclusions out of twenty-six is normal; an unusually high exclusion rate may mean the export format or the channel changed.
4. Do not edit the source file to force an inclusion. Use the post decision controls instead, so the decision is recorded.

3.2 Post decisions

For each questionable post, choose:

- **Include in story processing** — the post is relevant and may contribute to a story.
- **Exclude from story processing** — the post should not be used.
- **Include as context only** — useful background, not a source of publishable claims.
- **Mark as promotional** — advertising or channel promotion.
- **Mark as channel administration** — a notice about the channel itself.
- **Mark as profanity/abuse** — abusive or unsuitable content.

Apply the decision and, where the interface offers it, record the reason. A later editor should be able to see why an unusual post was included.

3.3 Clustering and corrections

Newsroom clusters duplicates, albums, replies and corrections. The cluster is the story. Open it from **Stories** and read:

- the **Claim ledger** — what the draft asserts, how it is attributed and whether it is verified;
- the **Source fragments** — the original messages;
- the **Chronology** — what changed and when;
- the **Research context** — accepted external references, if any.

A correction supersedes an earlier claim without deleting it. That is the correct behaviour: the record should show both the original statement and the correction. Do not "clean up" history by deleting the earlier claim.

3.4 Verification states

The claim ledger uses labels such as `official_statement`, `single_source`, `unverified` and `superseded`. Treat them as editorial signals:

State	What it means	What to do
`official_statement`	Attributed to an official body.	Check that the body actually said it, and whether the statement is self-serving.
`single_source`	One source only.	Seek corroboration or attribute clearly.
`unverified`	No independent confirmation.	Attribute, qualify, or hold.
`superseded`	A later claim replaced it.	Use the later figure and explain the correction if readers saw the earlier one.

An official statement can still be wrong. A single source can still be right. The label describes the evidence, not the truth.

---

4. Drafting with AI — and without it

4.1 What the fixture composer does

The synthetic fixture desk uses a deterministic composer. It does not need Ollama or a model. Fixture drafts are useful for learning the workflow, but they are not evidence that a real local model works on your machine.

4.2 What a real local model does

For a real channel, Newsroom drafts through a local Qwen3.5 model served by Ollama. The model must be installed, selected and tested on **AI Models**. Until the local test passes, source drafting is not considered ready.

The model works from the selected source fragments and the publication's instructions. It can:

- summarise and organise source material;
- propose a headline, deck and structure;
- produce a draft in the requested genre;
- paraphrase source material. Translation may be attempted, but translation quality was not verified for this documentation.

It can also:

- omit a qualification that matters;
- merge two events incorrectly;
- invent a plausible detail;
- overstate certainty;
- reproduce source wording too closely;
- produce a fluent paragraph that is not supported by the evidence.

None of these failures is unusual. The independent audit helps, but it checks traceability and quality signals, not truth.

4.3 A safe drafting routine

1. Confirm the source window and the rights state.
2. Build only when the model has passed its local test, or use the fixture desk for practice.
3. Open each article and read the **Draft text** against **Source evidence**.
4. Check every number, name, place and quotation.
5. Read the **Claims** table. Resolve `unverified` and `superseded` items.
6. Rewrite anything the model has overstated. Prefer plain attribution: "the department said", "according to the statement".
7. Add context a local reader needs, but do not add facts that are not in the evidence.
8. Lock the text when it is approved so a later run cannot replace it.

> **Do not publish a model output because the audit is green.** A green audit means the draft is traceable and meets some style and length checks. It does not mean the reporting is correct.

4.4 When not to use AI

Use human writing, or hold the story, when:

- the story relies on a single anonymous source;
- the allegation is legally sensitive;
- the source text is ambiguous or contradictory;
- the material is in a language the model handles poorly;
- the story requires original analysis of documents;
- the publication's policy forbids model drafting for that section.

The application does not prevent you from drafting such a story. Editorial policy must.

---

5. Human review

5.1 The three questions

For every article, an editor should be able to answer:

1. **What does this piece assert?** Read the claim ledger, not only the prose.
2. **What supports each assertion?** Name the post, document or accepted reference.
3. **What could be wrong, unfair or dangerous?** Then decide whether the risk is acceptable.

If you cannot answer the first two, the article is not ready. If the third answer is "I don't know", hold it.

5.2 Reading the review panels

The article editor presents several independent signals:

- **Audit** — citation coverage, supported fact sentences and available claims.
- **Style lint** — stock phrases and repeated openings.
- **Independent quality pass** — length and lead construction against the genre expectation.
- **Review items** — the blocking list, with **Approve item** and **Reject item**.
- **Publication held** — the notice that release is blocked.

Approve an item only when you have made the editorial decision it asks for. Reject it only when the item is wrong for this article, and be ready to explain why. Neither button edits the copy.

5.3 Quality items are not all equal

A quality item that says an opinion article is shorter than expected may be a legitimate editorial choice. A quality item that says a news article is fifteen words long usually signals a drafting failure. Read the article before deciding.

Length thresholds are genre-based, not universal. A brief is meant to be short. An analysis is not. If you routinely override the same item, the publication's genre or threshold may need review.

5.4 Risk items

An elevated-risk story needs a named editor's decision. Check:

- whether the headline overstates the evidence;
- whether a casualty figure is current;
- whether an allegation is attributed and balanced;
- whether a named person has had a chance to respond where the story warrants it;
- whether an image identifies a private person or reveals a location;
- whether publishing could endanger a source.

Newsroom records the decision. It does not make it.

5.5 Status discipline

Use the article status deliberately:

- **Draft** — work in progress.
- **Needs review** — ready for an editor but not approved.
- **Needs research** — a specific gap must be filled.
- **Approved** — accepted for a clean release.
- **Held** — deliberately kept out of release.
- **Excluded** — removed from the edition.

Do not mark an article **Approved** merely to clear the release button. The release button is not the goal; a defensible edition is.

5.6 Locks and revision history

Lock article and **Lock this headline and text against regeneration** protect approved work. The revision history records each saved state. If a later change is disputed, the history shows what was saved and when.

A lock is not a substitute for a backup. Keep the data folder backed up, especially before a large edition.

6. Media selection

6.1 Eligibility

The article editor offers source assets from the local cache. It does not browse the internet for images. An image may be technically eligible and still unusable because:

- the rights grant does not cover images;
- the image is a test plate or a placeholder;
- the image has been altered or is undated;
- the caption would identify a private person;
- the image is too graphic for the page;
- the image does not show what the caption claims.

6.2 Captions and credits

Every image needs an accurate caption and credit. The caption should say what the image shows, where and when, and who took or supplied it. The credit should name the rights holder as required by the grant.

Do not use a generic caption such as “scene of the incident” for an image that shows a different location or a later moment. Do not crop out a watermark or credit.

6.3 Layout limits

Briefs and narrow columns do not receive a second picture. The layout may drop a supporting image to keep the page legible. If an image is essential to the story, give the story enough space and check the preview.

6.4 The fixture plates

The demonstration edition includes synthetic plates labelled **Fixture test plate A/B/C** and **Not documentary evidence**. They exist to test albums and layout. They must never appear in a real publication.

---

7. Layout and preview

7.1 What the layout engine decides

The layout engine places articles by section, genre and available space. It applies the publication’s theme, paper size, section order and type metrics. It can produce a technically valid page that is editorially poor: a thin page, an awkward jump or a headline that loses its meaning across a column break.

7.2 What the editor must check

Open the preview PDF and inspect every page at a readable zoom:

- Is the front page the right lead?
- Does every headline fit without clipping?

- Are decks and standfirsts attached to the right stories?
- Are images correctly captioned and credited?
- Are page numbers, running heads and section labels correct?
- Are there blank, duplicated or underfull pages?
- Does the last page end cleanly?
- Is the QR code, if any, pointing at a real target?

The **Edition quality** panel reports page count, warnings, page fill and underfull pages. Underfull pages are reported, not treated as a proof failure. A page that is 11% full is worth a second look even if the PDF is valid.

7.3 Stale previews

If you change copy after rendering, the preview is stale. The workspace says so and offers **Rebuild preview only**. A stale preview must not be released. The published PDF would not match the text you approved.

7.4 Typography and language

Check that the chosen fonts cover the scripts in the issue. The **Appearance** page warns when a font has no Urdu glyph coverage and falls back. A fallback may render, but it can look inconsistent and may not shape the script correctly. Inspect the proof.

Do not reduce body type below the allowed minimum to force a fit. Rewrite or reflow instead.

---

8. Release

8.1 The release decision

Release is the moment a working edition becomes a published record. Before choosing **Release version N**, confirm:

- [ ] Every article is approved, held or excluded deliberately.
- [ ] Every blocking review item has a decision.
- [ ] The preview is current.
- [ ] Every page has been inspected.
- [ ] Images, captions and credits are correct.
- [ ] Names, numbers and quotations have been checked against the evidence.
- [ ] The edition name, date and volume are correct.
- [ ] The publication's legal or editorial sign-off process has been followed.

8.2 What release does

Release version N renders the latest saved revisions and freezes the version. The status becomes **Published**, an **Immutable release** badge appears, and the manifest and checksums are fixed. There is no automatic upload to a website, social network or wire service.

8.3 What release does not do

- It does not fact-check the issue.
- It does not obtain legal review.
- It does not grant rights you do not have.
- It does not publish to a remote audience.
- It does not prevent a later correction; it preserves the original as a version.

8.4 Outputs

A released edition provides:

Output	Use
Published PDF	The print-ready tabloid or A3 file.
E-paper	The offline page-turner, text edition and source appendix.
Open preview PDF	The working preview, when it still exists.

The files live under `%LOCALAPPDATA%\ChannelPress\output\<publication-slug>\<edition-folder>\`. The **Provenance** panel names the exact folder. Do not rename or edit files in a published folder.

8.5 Distribution

Newsroom does not upload. Distribution is a separate human step: print, copy to a shared drive, send to a printer, or hand the PDF to whoever operates the website. If you publish the e-paper online, you are responsible for the hosting, access control and any personal data in the bundle.

---

9. Corrections and immutable versions

9.1 Why versions are immutable

A published edition is a record. If the PDF could be edited in place, a reader could not tell what was originally published, and an audit trail would be meaningless. Immutability protects the publication as much as the reader.

9.2 Correcting a published edition

1. Open the published edition.
2. Choose **Open working version N+1**. This creates a draft from the latest saved revisions.
3. Make the correction in the article editor.
4. Record what changed and why in the revision or an editorial note.

5. Re-run the audit if the change affects a claim.
6. Resolve any new review item.
7. Rebuild the preview and inspect the affected pages.
8. Release version N+1.

Version N remains available with its original manifest. Do not delete it.

9.3 Correction notice

A correction should be visible to readers, not only in the archive. Add a correction line or a short notice in the article and, where the publication uses one, on the cover or in a corrections column. State what was wrong and what is now correct. Avoid quietly replacing a figure.

9.4 Withdrawals

If a story must be withdrawn rather than corrected, hold or exclude the article in a new working version and explain the withdrawal to readers. Do not remove the original version from the archive. If the withdrawal is legally sensitive, take advice before publishing an explanation.

9.5 Source withdrawals

If a source withdraws a post, Newsroom records the withdrawal and blocks the material from new processing. A previously published edition does not change. Decide whether the published story needs a correction or a note, and follow the version process if it does.

---

10. QR citations, source appendix and e-paper

10.1 Source code policy

Branding → Source code policy has three options:

- **One compact code per story when a verified public target exists**;
- **Verified public target only**;
- **No printed codes**.

Choose **No printed codes** if you do not operate a stable public source page. A QR code that leads to a missing or private page is worse than no code.

10.2 The public evidence URL

Public evidence-page base URL is used only when you genuinely publish evidence pages. The checkbox **I have verified that the public evidence-page base URL serves the exported source bundles** is a deliberate confirmation. Tick it only after opening the URL and checking that it works without a login.

On the tested installation the public source list was not configured, and the app reported that printed QRs stay in **truthful source appendix mode**. That is the safe default.

10.3 The e-paper

The e-paper bundle is self-contained. It includes page navigation, a text edition and a source appendix. Open it from the edition's **E-paper** button.



Figure 1. The e-paper viewer for the published synthetic edition, with page navigation and a source appendix.

Before distributing an e-paper:

- open it on a machine that is not running Newsroom;
- check that every page loads;
- check the text edition for garbled characters;
- check the source appendix for private or irrelevant material;
- check that external links are correct;
- confirm the bundle does not contain source media you are not licensed to distribute.

10.4 The printed page



SYNTHETIC FIXTURE EDITION — NOT FOR PUBLICATION. SOURCE POSTS ARE SYNTHETIC TEST DATA.

WEDNESDAY, 21 OCTOBER 2026 PKT · MANUAL EDITION · VOL. 1 NO. 1 · KARACHI

The Channel Dispatch

A source-transparent roundup for the region · @fixture_newsroom

CONFLICT & WAR

Four soldiers wounded in Chaman border bombing as clearance operation continues

BY EDITORIAL DESK

The border crossing stays shut until Wednesday, with freight backed up on the Pakistani side

A roadside bomb struck a military vehicle on Monday evening. The military later corrected the police casualty count from three to four.

FIXTURE TEST PLATE A fixture test plate supplied with the demonstration post. It is not a photograph of the reported incident. CREDIT: CHANNEL PRESS FIXTURE SET

A roadside bomb struck a military vehicle in the Chaman border area on Monday evening, wounding four soldiers, the military's media wing said, correcting an earlier police count of three.

Security forces launched a clearance operation after the blast, the provincial counterterrorism department said. The military said on Tuesday that the operation was continuing and gave no timeline for reopening the border crossing.

The district administration said the crossing would remain closed until Wednesday morning. Traders said hundreds of trucks were waiting on the Pakistani side.

Two of the wounded soldiers were in stable condition at a Quetta hospital, according to the military account. A hospital official, speaking on condition of anonymity because he was not authorised to brief media, said two wounded soldiers were treated and discharged on Monday night. That account could not be independently corroborated.

No group had claimed responsibility.

The channel initially reported that the operation had ended, then published a correction saying it was continuing.

CHRONOLOGY

20 Oct, 11:10	Security forces launched a clearance operation in the Chaman border area on Monday evening after a roadside bomb struck a military vehicle, the provincial counterterrorism department said.	ATTRIBUTED
20 Oct, 12:05	Correction published: Update: The military's media wing says four soldiers were wounded, correcting an earlier police count of three.	CORRECTED
20 Oct, 12:40	Photographs released by the department show the damaged vehicle and security personnel at the scene.	REPORTED
20 Oct, 13:20	The district administration said the border crossing would remain closed until Wednesday morning.	ATTRIBUTED
20 Oct, 14:02	A hospital official, speaking on condition of anonymity because he was not authorised to brief media, said two of the wounded soldiers were treated and discharged on Monday night.	ATTRIBUTED
20 Oct, 15:15	The military's media wing confirmed on Tuesday that four soldiers were wounded in the Chaman roadside bombing and that a clearance operation was continuing.	REPORTED

Showing the first 6 of 7 dated entries. The remaining 1 are held in the edition source record and are not printed here.

Sources: A1, A2, A3, A4 and 3 more · appendix p. 5

The channel published a correction to an earlier report. This article uses the corrected figure and records the change in its source appendix.

FRONT BRIEFS

CONFLICT & WAR
Police officer wounded in Bannu checkpoint attack
Gunmen attacked a checkpoint in Bannu district on Monday, wounding one police officer, police said.
FULL REPORT, PAGE 3

CONFLICT & WAR
Roadside bomb damages ambulance in Swat, no casualties
A roadside bomb damaged an ambulance in Swat district on Monday.
FULL REPORT, PAGE 3

DEFENCE & SECURITY
Air force concludes southern air-defence exercise
The air force said it concluded a five-day exercise in the southern region on Monday.
FULL REPORT, PAGE 2

DEFENCE & SECURITY
Navy to host multilateral maritime exercise
The navy said it would host a multilateral maritime exercise next month.
FULL REPORT, PAGE 2

INSIDE

Regional	2
Defence & Security	2
Conflict & War	2
Analysis	1
Opinion & Editorial	1
Briefs	6
Sources & provenance	appendix

About this edition. This edition is an editorial roundup based primarily on authorized posts published by the owner's source channel; it is not staffed eyewitness journalism. Compiled from @fixture_newsroom by the Editorial Desk. Every factual statement is traced to a dated source message in the appendix; analysis and opinion are labelled. This is a synthetic demonstration edition built only from repository fixture data. It is not a real news report and must not be published as journalism.

MORE FROM THIS EDITION

BRIEFS
Cabinet approves searchable procurement records policy
The federal cabinet approved a national digital records policy on Tuesday, requiring ministries to...
FULL REPORT, PAGE 4

BRIEFS
Pakistan and Iran agree to reopen border-trade talks
Pakistan and Iran agreed to reopen talks on border trade at a meeting in Tehran, the foreign ministry said.
FULL REPORT, PAGE 4

BRIEFS
State Bank holds policy rate at 19.5pc as food prices persist
The State Bank held its policy rate at 19.5 percent on Monday, citing persistent inflation.
FULL REPORT, PAGE 4

BRIEFS
Market reopens after repairs, committee says
A local market reopened after repairs on Tuesday, the market committee said.
FULL REPORT, PAGE 4

BRIEFS
Flood compensation portal still rejecting claims, applicants say
The provincial government's flood compensation portal is still rejecting applications from last year's...
FULL REPORT, PAGE 4

BRIEFS
Border closure hurts traders, association says
The closure of the border trade route has hurt traders, a local traders' association said.
FULL REPORT, PAGE 4

Figure 2. A page from the published synthetic edition. The newspaper uses its own masthead; the Newsroom identity does not appear inside the paper.

The PDF is a print artefact, not a web page. Check it in a PDF reader at print size and, where possible, on paper before a large run. Confirm the paper size matches the printer’s stock. The tested edition was 5 pages at 792 × 1224 pt (11 × 17 in) with selectable text.

11. Editorial checklist for every issue

Before the build

- [ ] The source has an active rights declaration.
- [ ] The cutoff window is correct and does not overlap the previous issue.
- [ ] The local model has passed its test, or the fixture desk is being used deliberately.
- [ ] The publication profile, paper size and section order are current.
- [ ] There is enough disk space for media and output.

During review

- [ ] Every article has been read against its evidence.
- [ ] Every number, name and quotation has been checked.
- [ ] Every `unverified` or `superseded` claim has a decision.
- [ ] High-risk stories have a named approver.
- [ ] Review items are approved or rejected with a reason.
- [ ] Images, captions and credits are correct.
- [ ] The text is locked where appropriate.

Before release

- [ ] The preview is current and every page has been inspected.
- [ ] There are no blank, clipped or duplicated pages.
- [ ] The edition name, date, volume and issue number are correct.
- [ ] The legal or editorial sign-off process is complete.
- [ ] A backup of the data folder exists.

After release

- [ ] The **Published PDF** opens.
- [ ] The **E-paper** opens and its sources are readable.
- [ ] The files are copied to the distribution location.
- [ ] The release is recorded in the publication's own log.
- [ ] Any correction is handled as a new version, not an edit in place.

---

12. What this product does not do

State these limits honestly to readers and staff:

- **No cloud publishing.** Release is local. There is no built-in website, newsletter, social or wire upload.

- **No guaranteed live Telegram.** The connection UI exists, but the installer does not configure API credentials. Live login and retrieval were unverified. The rights-cleared JSON import is the verified route.
- **No bundled AI.** Ollama and model weights are separate, large downloads. Model quality and speed depend on the machine.
- **No automatic fact-checking.** The audit checks traceability and style signals. It cannot establish truth.
- **No unattended scheduler while the app is closed.** The installer does not create a Windows task. Schedules define policy and support manual run and catch-up.
- **No in-app backup button.** Back up by closing the app and copying the data folder.
- **No EPUB, HTML newsletter or email export.** The verified outputs are the PDF, page proofs and the e-paper bundle.
- **No legal review.** Editorial and legal responsibility remain with the publication.

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13. Related manuals

- **Quick Start** — install and produce a first preview.
- **User Manual** — every verified screen and control.
- **Installation & Maintenance** — backup, restore and safe operation.
- **Troubleshooting & FAQ** — recovery when a build or release fails.
- **Documentation Index** — the full document map.

NEWSROOM · DOCUMENT 04

Installation & Maintenance

Install, update, back up and restore

Product: Newsroom 1.0.0 for Windows
Audience: The Windows user who owns and maintains the installation
Last verified against: `NewsroomSetup.exe` 1.0.0 (288,395,624 bytes) and the packaged build of 31 October 2026

This manual covers installation, updates, file locations, backup, restore, uninstall, disk use, background operation, networking and local-data privacy. It uses Windows interface conventions wherever possible. It does not require Python, a terminal or repository access.

> **Scope note:** the installer and package layout were inspected directly, and the packaged application was run against a disposable profile. A full clean-machine update and uninstall re-test was not repeated for this documentation. Where a behaviour was not exercised, this manual says so.

1. What you receive

Item	Details
Installer	`NewsroomSetup.exe`, version 1.0.0, 288,395,624 bytes
Installed application	`Newsroom.exe` and its support files
Default install folder	`%LOCALAPPDATA%\Programs\Newsroom`
Approximate installed size	About 831 MB
Shortcuts	**Newsroom** in the Start Menu; desktop shortcut optional
Separately installed	Microsoft Edge WebView2 Runtime, if missing
Not bundled	Ollama, AI model weights, FFmpeg

The installer is per-user. It installs into the current Windows account's local application folder and normally does not request administrator rights. The application is 64-bit.

The installer does **not** contain a cloud account, subscription, product key or online activation step. It also does not install a Windows service, a scheduled task or an automatic startup entry.

1.1 Components needed at run time

Component	Status	Why it matters
Windows 10 or Windows 11, 64-bit	Required	The packaged application targets 64-bit Windows.

Component	Status	Why it matters
Microsoft Edge WebView2 Runtime	Required; installed by setup if missing	Renders the application window.
Bundled Chromium print browser	Included in the package	Renders the print PDF.
Paged.js renderer and PyMuPDF	Included	Layout and PDF geometry inspection.
fontTools	Included	Installed-font discovery and font validation.
OpenCV	Included	Video still extraction fallback.
FFmpeg	Optional	Better video still extraction; OpenCV is used when FFmpeg is absent.
Ollama	Optional, separate	Serves local Qwen3.5 models.
AI model weights	Optional, separate	2.68–6.55 GB per reviewed profile.
Internet access	Optional for editing; needed for WebView2 bootstrap, model downloads, live Telegram and external research	Local editing and viewing already-downloaded editions work offline.

The fixture demonstration and the PDF/e-paper workflow do not require Ollama or a model.

---

2. Install Newsroom

1. Double-click `NewsroomSetup.exe`.
2. If Windows SmartScreen warns about an unrecognised publisher, choose **More info** and **Run anyway** only if you obtained the file from the owner or the approved release location. This build is not code-signed.
3. Choose **Next** on the welcome page.
4. Keep `%LOCALAPPDATA%\Programs\Newsroom` unless you have a specific reason to change it. The folder is private to your Windows account.
5. Leave **Create a desktop shortcut** selected if you want one. The Start Menu shortcut is always created.
6. Choose **Install**.
7. If WebView2 is missing, setup runs Microsoft's signed bootstrapper silently. This needs an internet connection and can take a few minutes.
8. Leave **Launch Newsroom** selected and choose **Finish**.

What you should see: one window titled **Newsroom**. There is no terminal window, browser address bar or separate worker console.

2.1 If setup cannot install WebView2

Setup stops with a message that the runtime could not be installed or was not detected. Check:

- the internet connection and any proxy;

- whether Microsoft Edge or another WebView2 application can update;
- whether an organisation policy blocks the runtime.

Install the current Microsoft Edge WebView2 Evergreen Runtime manually, then run `NewsroomSetup.exe` again. Newsroom cannot render its window without it.

2.2 First run

The first launch shows **Set up Newsroom**. Create the owner account, choose a display name and a password of at least 12 characters, and decide whether to create the synthetic fixture channel. The fixture is for practice and is labelled synthetic.

Keep the owner password safe. There is no email-based reset in the installed application. An owner can reset another user's password from **Users**; losing the only owner password requires help from whoever maintains the installation.

---

3. Where files are stored

`%LOCALAPPDATA%` is usually `C:\Users\<your Windows user>\AppData\Local`. Paste the path into File Explorer's address bar.

Item	Default location	Notes
Program files	`%LOCALAPPDATA%\Programs\Newsroom`	Replaced on update.
Your data	`%LOCALAPPDATA%\ChannelPress`	Database, media, settings, fonts and sessions.
Published editions	`%LOCALAPPDATA%\ChannelPress\output`	One folder per publication and edition.
Logs	`%LOCALAPPDATA%\ChannelPress\logs`	Desktop and worker logs.
Database	`%LOCALAPPDATA%\ChannelPress\channel_press.db`	SQLite database in WAL mode.
Telegram session	Under the data folder	Created only after a successful live login. Treat it like a password.
Imported fonts	Under the data folder	Stored by checksum.
Ollama models	Managed by Ollama, outside the Newsroom data folder	Not counted in the Newsroom data size.

The folder name `ChannelPress` is retained for compatibility with the application's former name. It is the current data folder; do not rename it.

The edition workspace's **Provenance** panel shows the exact folder for a released edition. A typical edition folder contains the PDF, page proofs, the e-paper bundle, a manifest and checksums.

3.1 Do not edit published files

A released edition is immutable. Renaming or editing files inside its folder breaks the manifest and checksums and destroys the audit trail. Make corrections through a new working version, not through File Explorer.

---

4. Update an existing installation

Newsroom is the current name of the application formerly distributed as **Channel Press**. The installer recognises an existing compatible installation and updates it in place.

4.1 Before updating

1. Close Newsroom with **Pause safely and exit**.
2. Confirm that no **Newsroom** or **NewsroomWorker** process remains in Task Manager.
3. Back up `%LOCALAPPDATA%\ChannelPress` as described in section 6.
4. Note the current version from **Diagnostics → About Newsroom** or from the installer.

4.2 Run the update

1. Run the newer `NewsroomSetup.exe`.
2. Setup detects the existing installation and shows a confirmation:

> An existing compatible installation was found (version …). This setup updates application files in place. Your personal data, Telegram sessions, settings and editions are stored separately and will not be removed. Continue?

3. Choose **Yes**.
4. Keep the same install folder.
5. Finish setup and launch Newsroom.

What you should see: the existing data, accounts, sources, drafts and editions are still present. The Start Menu and desktop shortcuts point to **Newsroom**, and the old `Channel Press` shortcuts and executable names are removed.

Do not uninstall the old application first. The installer's upgrade path is designed to preserve the data folder, and uninstalling adds risk without benefit.

4.3 If the update fails

- Read the setup message before closing it.
- Confirm Newsroom is not running.
- Confirm there is enough disk space for the new files plus the existing data.
- Run the same installer again; it is safe to repeat.
- Do not delete the data folder to "start clean". Restore from backup only if the data is actually damaged.

A clean-machine update re-test was not performed for this documentation. The upgrade prompt and install behaviour were inspected in the installer configuration and the release report.

---

5. Repair

There is no separate **Repair** entry in the installed application. To repair a damaged program installation:

1. Close Newsroom with **Pause safely and exit**.
2. Run the same `NewsroomSetup.exe` over the existing installation.
3. Choose **Yes** when setup offers to update the files in place.

This replaces program files but does not replace your data. If the window is blank because WebView2 is broken, repair WebView2 first; reinstalling Newsroom will not fix a blocked runtime.

---

6. Backup

There is no in-app backup button. The supported manual method is to copy the whole data folder while Newsroom is closed.

6.1 What to back up

Back up the entire `%LOCALAPPDATA%\ChannelPress` folder. It contains more than the database:

- `channel_press.db` and its WAL/SHM files;
- source media and derivatives;
- published editions and e-paper bundles;
- imported fonts;
- settings and any Telegram session;
- logs.

Copying only the `.db` file is not a complete backup.

6.2 A safe backup procedure

1. In Newsroom, choose **Pause safely and exit** and wait for the window to close.
2. Open Task Manager and confirm there is no **Newsroom** or **NewsroomWorker** process.
3. Open `%LOCALAPPDATA%` in File Explorer.
4. Right-click the `ChannelPress` folder and choose **Copy**.
5. Paste it to a different drive or a verified backup location.
6. Rename the copy with the date, for example `ChannelPress-backup-2026-10-31`.
7. If the backup tool offers verification, run it. Otherwise open the copy and confirm that `channel_press.db` and `output` are present.

Do not back up while a build is running. A copied WAL database can be inconsistent if the application is still writing.

6.3 How often

- Before every application update.

- Before a Windows feature update.
- Before a large or high-value edition.
- On a regular schedule that matches how much work you can afford to lose.

Keep at least one backup on a different physical drive. A copy in the same folder is not a backup against disk failure.

---

7. Restore

Restore only when the current data is damaged or lost, and keep the damaged folder until the restore is verified.

1. Close Newsroom with **Pause safely and exit**.
2. Confirm that no Newsroom process is running.
3. Rename the current `%LOCALAPPDATA%\ChannelPress` folder to `ChannelPress-old-YYYYMMDD`. Do not delete it yet.
4. Copy the verified backup folder to `%LOCALAPPDATA%`.
5. Rename the copied folder to exactly `ChannelPress`.
6. Start Newsroom and sign in.
7. Check the Dashboard counts, open a recent edition, and open its **Published PDF** and **E-paper**.
8. Check **Jobs** for interrupted work before starting a new build.
9. Only after the restore is verified, remove the old folder when you are sure you no longer need it.

Success check: the expected newspaper, sources, editions and accounts are present, and a published edition opens. If the app shows **Set up Newsroom**, it is using a different data folder or the database was not restored to the right path.

Restore was not exercised end to end for this documentation. Test a restore on a disposable machine or profile before relying on it for a critical archive.

7.1 Restoring only an edition

If you need one edition rather than the whole archive, copy its folder from the backup's `output\<publication-slug>\` into the live output folder while Newsroom is closed. Keep the manifest and checksums together. Do not merge two different editions into one folder.

---

8. Uninstall

8.1 Standard uninstall

1. Close Newsroom with **Pause safely and exit**.
2. Open Windows **Settings → Apps → Installed apps**.

3. Find **Newsroom** and choose **Uninstall**.
4. Follow the uninstaller.

You can also use the uninstall entry in the Start Menu folder if present. The uninstaller removes the program files and shortcuts.

8.2 What happens to your data

The data folder `%LOCALAPPDATA%\ChannelPress` is outside the installation folder and is not part of the uninstall. Your database, media, editions, fonts and sessions are preserved by design.

If you intend to remove the data as well:

1. Make a backup first.
2. Confirm that you no longer need the archive.
3. Delete `%LOCALAPPDATA%\ChannelPress` manually in File Explorer.

Deleting the data folder cannot be undone. Do not do it to troubleshoot a startup error before reading **Troubleshooting & FAQ**.

8.3 Reinstall after uninstall

Install the same or a newer version. If the data folder is still present, the existing owner account and archive should be available at sign-in. If you removed the data folder, first run shows **Set up Newsroom** again.

A full uninstall/reinstall cycle was not repeated for this documentation.

---

9. Disk use and local models

9.1 Application and data

- Installed application: about 831 MB.
- Data: depends on the archive, source media and editions. The Diagnostics page reports free space against a quota target, not the size of your archive.
- A single edition with images can add tens or hundreds of megabytes.

Check free space before a large build. The **Connections** and **Diagnostics** pages report free disk space in the data volume.

9.2 Models

The reviewed local models are separate downloads:

Profile	Model	Download
Standard	`qwen3.5:4b-q4_K_M`	3.32 GB
Enhanced	`qwen3.5:9b-q4_K_M`	6.55 GB
Compact	`qwen3.5:2b`	2.68 GB

Ollama stores the weights in its own location, outside `%LOCALAPPDATA%\ChannelPress`. Removing a model is an Ollama management task, not a Newsroom data operation. Newsroom does not bundle Ollama and will not start a service it does not own.

Allow temporary space for a download in addition to the final model size. A failed download does not change a published edition.

9.3 Media cache

Media cache shows a dry run of deletable files and a protected set. The protection list includes media referenced by active or awaiting-review editions, editor locks, provenance and rights records, source post records and uncertain files. Treat both clear buttons as destructive and back up the data folder first. The feature was not exercised for this documentation.

---

10. Starting, background operation and shutdown

10.1 Starting

Launch **Newsroom** from the Start Menu or the desktop shortcut. The application starts its local service and opens one window. The first window may take a few seconds while the database opens.

Only one window can run at a time. Launching again focuses the existing window rather than starting a second copy. This protects the database and any Telegram session.

10.2 Background work

A build starts a one-shot worker outside the browser request. If you hide the window with **Continue in background**, the worker continues. The worker is still a process on this computer; it is not a cloud job.

The installer does not create:

- a Windows service;
- a scheduled task;
- an automatic startup entry;
- an unattended overnight build.

Schedules in the app define cutoff and release policy and support **Run the latest cutoff now** and **Enqueue missed cutoffs**. Automatic execution while the application is closed was not verified and should not be relied on.

10.3 Safe shutdown

Close the window with the X and choose:

Choice	Result
Continue in background	Hides the window; the local service and queued work continue. Launch again to restore the window.
Pause safely and exit	Waits for the worker and model operations to reach safe checkpoints, then stops the local service.

Choice	Result
Keep open	Returns to the application.

Use **Pause safely and exit** before backup, update, uninstall or a Windows restart. If it seems to hang, wait; a model call or page render may still be reaching a checkpoint. End the process only after several minutes of no response, then recover the job from **Jobs**.

10.4 After a restart

Open **Jobs** before starting new work. A job interrupted by a restart may be paused, resumable or retryable. Use **Continue from checkpoint** or **Retry failed job** after understanding the cause. Do not create a duplicate build for the same window.

---

11. Network, firewall and privacy

11.1 What needs the network

Activity	Network needed
Install or update if WebView2 is missing	Yes, to Microsoft's bootstrapper.
Open and edit existing local editions	No.
Build from the fixture desk	No.
Build from a rights-cleared JSON import	No, once the file and media are local.
Draft with a local model	No internet, but the local Ollama service must be reachable.
Download or verify a model	Yes, from the verified Ollama registry.
Live Telegram login and retrieval	Yes, and API credentials must be configured.
External research providers	Yes, when a provider is configured and triggered.
View a published PDF or e-paper	No.

The local service listens on loopback. If a firewall or endpoint-protection product blocks loopback or the worker process, the window may open but builds or previews fail. Allow the application on private/local connections rather than disabling the firewall.

11.2 Proxy and regional restrictions

Newsroom has no built-in proxy or circumvention tool. If the computer uses a proxy, configure it at the Windows or browser level so WebView2 and the model downloader can reach their services. Telegram may be unreachable on some networks or in some regions; use a network on which it is legitimately available or use the rights-cleared import path. Do not assume that a VPN is supported by the application.

11.3 Local data and privacy

- The database, media derivatives and published bundles stay under the local data and output folders.
- The footer states **Data stays on this computer.**

- There is no account, cloud sync or subscription screen in the inspected build.
- No telemetry or analytics setting is exposed in the application.
- Credentials are optional and stored outside Git.
- The Telegram session file behaves like a password. Anyone with a copy can act as that account until it is revoked. Sign out from the source connection page to remove it.
- Logs can contain local paths, job details and error text. Review a log before sending it to anyone.
- A published PDF or e-paper may contain source material, names and images. Treat the output with the same care as the reporting.

11.4 Multiple Windows accounts

The installer is per-user. Each Windows account has its own program folder and its own data folder. A second Windows user does not automatically see the first user's newspapers. To move an archive between Windows accounts, copy the data folder while Newsroom is closed, then place it in the second account's `%LOCALAPPDATA%`.

---

12. Maintenance schedule

A simple routine keeps the installation healthy:

When	Task
Daily	Check **Connections** if something seems wrong; resolve review items before release.
Weekly	Confirm a current backup exists on a different drive.
Monthly	Check free disk space, review **Media cache** dry run, and read the **Audit** trail for unexpected changes.
Before every update	Close safely, back up the data folder, note the version.
After every update	Sign in, open a recent edition, open its PDF and e-paper, and check **Jobs**.
Quarterly	Test a restore on a disposable profile or machine.
When staff change	Disable unused accounts and reset shared credentials.

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13. Related manuals

- **Quick Start** — install and produce a first preview.
- **User Manual** — every verified screen and control.
- **Editorial & Publishing Guide** — review, release and corrections.
- **Troubleshooting & FAQ** — recovery when something fails.
- **Documentation Index** — the full document map.

NEWSROOM · DOCUMENT 05

Troubleshooting & FAQ

Symptoms, safe steps and recovery

Product: Newsroom 1.0.0 for Windows
Audience: Owners, editors and operators using the installed application
Last verified against: the packaged build of 31 October 2026

Use this manual when something does not behave as expected. Start with the symptom table, then follow the detailed section. Prefer safe, reversible steps. Do not delete the database, the Telegram session, `.env` or the data folder to "fix" a problem unless a section explicitly says to restore from a verified backup.

> **Before you change anything:** if the application still opens, go to **Connections** and **Diagnostics** and note the exact status and message. If a job failed, open the job and note its number, stage and error text. That information makes the next step much safer.

1. Quick symptom table

Symptom	Likely area	Go to
Installer does not start, or stops with a WebView2 message	Windows runtime / installer	§2
Window opens but never reaches the sign-in page	Startup / WebView2 / database	§3
Cannot sign in, or account is locked	Sign-in	§4
Second launch does not open a second window	Single-instance design	§5
Closing the window seems to hang	Worker checkpoint	§5
Sources says Telegram credentials are missing	Live Telegram configuration	§6
Telegram login code does not arrive, or login expires	Telegram authentication	§6
Telegram says the channel is private or inaccessible	Account membership / rights	§6
AI Models says runtime unavailable	Ollama service	§7
Model download fails, stops at a percentage, or runs out of disk	Model transfer	§7
Model is installed but drafting refuses to start	Model test / digest	§7
Build stays queued or a job seems stuck	Worker / job	§8
Build says **Awaiting review** and will not release	Editorial review	§9
Preview PDF is old, blank or does not refresh	Preview / renderer	§10
Text is clipped, pages are blank or underfull	Layout / copy / theme	§10
Images do not appear	Media cache / source media	§11
Urdu or another script appears in the wrong font	Font coverage	§11
QR code or source appendix is missing	Public evidence URL / source code policy	§12

Symptom	Likely area	Go to
Database temporarily busy message	Concurrent write	§13
The computer restarted during a build	Job recovery	§8
A schedule did not run by itself	Scheduler limitation	§14
Need to recover lost data	Backup / restore	§15
Need to send a problem report	Logs and privacy	§16

2. The installer does not start or stops early

The installer is blocked by Windows

Possible cause: Windows SmartScreen or an organisational policy does not recognise the publisher. This build is not code-signed.

Safe steps:

1. Confirm you have the `NewsroomSetup.exe` that belongs to this release. Do not use a copy from an unknown source.
2. In the SmartScreen prompt, choose **More info** and then **Run anyway** only if you obtained the file from the owner or the approved release location.
3. If an organisation manages the PC, ask its administrator before overriding a policy.

Setup says WebView2 could not be installed

Possible cause: no internet connection, a proxy or firewall blocks Microsoft's download, or WebView2 installation is disabled by policy.

Safe steps:

1. Connect to the internet and run setup again.
2. If the PC uses a proxy, make sure Windows and Microsoft Edge can reach the internet.
3. If the runtime is already installed but setup does not detect it, install the current Microsoft Edge WebView2 Evergreen Runtime from Microsoft, then run `NewsroomSetup.exe` again.
4. If policy blocks the runtime, ask the administrator to allow it. Newsroom cannot render its window without WebView2.

Setup stops on an existing installation

Possible cause: Newsroom (or the earlier Channel Press) is already installed for this Windows account.

Safe steps:

1. Read the prompt. It should say that application files will be updated in place and that personal data, Telegram sessions, settings and editions are stored separately.
2. Choose **Yes** to update. Do not uninstall first.

3. If setup refuses because the application is running, close Newsroom with **Pause safely and exit**, then retry.

See **Installation & Maintenance** for the full upgrade and uninstall behaviour.

---

3. The window opens but never reaches sign-in

The window shows a startup error

Possible cause: the local service did not start, the database could not be opened, or a migration could not complete.

Safe steps:

1. Close the error window. Do not delete the data folder.
2. Open `%LOCALAPPDATA%\ChannelPress\logs` in File Explorer.
3. Open the newest `desktop-YYYYMMDD.log` and read the last few lines. A message such as `desktop_start_failed` or `desktop_api_shutdown_timeout` identifies the failing stage.
4. Make sure no other Newsroom process is running: open Task Manager, look for **Newsroom** and **NewsroomWorker**, and end only those tasks if they are unresponsive.
5. Start Newsroom again. If it still fails, copy the log file for support as described in §16.

The window is blank or white

Possible cause: WebView2 failed to initialise, or the local page was interrupted.

Safe steps:

1. Close Newsroom with **Pause safely and exit** if the window responds.
2. Reopen it from the Start Menu.
3. If the window stays blank, check **Connections → Windows desktop runtime**. A missing or broken WebView2 runtime must be repaired or reinstalled.
4. Restart Windows once. This clears a stuck WebView2 child process.

Do not reinstall the application as the first response; it will not repair a blocked WebView2 runtime and it risks unnecessary churn.

---

4. Cannot sign in

The password is rejected

Possible cause: passwords are case-sensitive; the username is not. Caps Lock, a keyboard layout change or a trailing space can cause a failure.

Safe steps:

1. Retype the password slowly with Caps Lock off.
2. Check the username. The default owner username is `owner` unless it was changed during setup.
3. If another owner can sign in, ask them to reset your password from **Users** → **Reset password**.
4. If the only owner password is lost, do not delete the database. The account cannot be recovered from the interface; seek help from whoever maintains the installation, and keep a copy of the data folder first.

The account is temporarily locked

Possible cause: five failed attempts within 15 minutes.

Safe steps: wait for the lockout window to pass, then try again once. Repeated attempts extend the delay. Do not create a new database to bypass the lock.

The app shows **Set up Newsroom** again

Possible cause: Newsroom is using a different data folder, or the database was replaced or removed.

Safe steps:

1. Do not complete setup over the old data if you expect existing editions.
2. Check that `%LOCALAPPDATA%\ChannelPress\channel_press.db` exists.
3. If you recently changed `CHANNEL_PRESS_DATA_DIR` or moved the application, restore the previous data folder path.
4. Restore from a backup if necessary; see §15.

---

5. Window, background and shutdown problems

A second launch does not open a second window

This is intentional. Newsroom is a single-window application. Starting it again focuses the existing window. If the window was hidden with **Continue in background**, launching again restores it.

If no window appears and Task Manager shows no **Newsroom** process, the application has exited. Start it normally.

Pause safely and exit takes a long time

Possible cause: a model operation, media download or page render is still reaching a checkpoint.

Safe steps:

1. Wait. The window may remain open while the current operation finishes.
2. Do not end the process unless it has been unresponsive for several minutes.
3. If it must be ended, use Task Manager to end **Newsroom** and **NewsroomWorker**, then reopen. A queued job should be recoverable from **Jobs**.
4. Check **Jobs** after reopening. A job interrupted by shutdown may be `paused`, `resumable` or `failed_retryable`.

The close dialog does not appear

The close choice is shown when you close the application window. If the window is already unresponsive, Windows may close it without showing the dialog. Reopen and check **Jobs** before starting new work.

The application is running in the background and I forgot

Open Task Manager and look for **Newsroom**. Or launch Newsroom again; it focuses the hidden window. Use **Pause safely and exit** when you are finished for the day, especially before backup, uninstall or Windows updates.

---

6. Telegram connection problems

> **Scope:** the installed build exposes the Telegram connection screens, but the API id/hash are not configured by the installer. Live Telegram login and retrieval could not be verified for this documentation. The verified alternative is the rights-cleared JSON import on the source page.

Missing or API id/hash are not configured

Meaning: this installation has no Telegram API application credentials, so it cannot open a live Telegram session.

Safe steps:

1. Continue with the **Import authorized content** path on the source page. It needs no Telegram account.
2. If live access is required, treat the API credentials as an owner-level configuration task outside the normal Newsroom screens. Do not paste API hashes, login codes or two-step passwords into a documentation request, chat or email.
3. Do not rename the channel or edit the database to make the warning disappear. The warning reflects a missing prerequisite, not a display bug.

The login code does not arrive

Possible cause: the phone number is not in international format, the Telegram account is not reachable, or a code was requested too many times.

Safe steps:

1. Confirm the number includes the country code and no local trunk prefix, for example `+92…`.
2. Check that the Telegram account can receive messages on another device.
3. Wait for the login window to expire before requesting another code. Repeated requests can trigger a rate limit.
4. Use **Cancel login** and start again only after the wait.

FloodWait or "too many attempts"

Meaning: Telegram has rate-limited the account.

Safe steps: stop retrying. Wait for the period stated by Telegram, then try once. Do not run the same request in a loop. If a collection was interrupted, the stored checkpoint may allow it to resume without re-fetching everything.

The channel is private or inaccessible

Possible cause: the signed-in account is not a member, the handle changed, or the channel was deleted.

Safe steps:

1. Join the channel with the authorised account, or ask the owner to grant access.
2. Save the exact `@handle` or `t.me` address on the connection page and use **Test source connection**.
3. Confirm the rights declaration is active. Public read access is not permission to republish.
4. If the channel identity changed, stop and verify that you are pointing at the intended source before collecting.

The session expired or was revoked

Possible cause: the local session is no longer valid, or the account signed out elsewhere.

Safe steps:

1. Sign in again on that channel's Telegram page.
2. If you intend to stop using the account, use **Sign out** on the Telegram page. That removes the local session through the application.
3. Do not delete `telegram.session` by hand while Newsroom is running. A session file behaves like a password.

Telegram session currently busy

Meaning: a worker or another Newsroom process is using the session.

Safe steps: wait for the current collection or build to finish, then use **Test source connection** again. Do not start a second Newsroom instance. If the message persists with no job running, close Newsroom with **Pause safely and exit** and reopen it.

Network restrictions and regional blocking

Telegram may be unreachable on some networks or in some regions. Newsroom does not include a built-in circumvention tool, and this manual does not recommend one. Use a network on which Telegram is legitimately available, or use the rights-cleared import path. Do not assume that a VPN or proxy is supported by the application; if you use one, it must be configured at the Windows network level and must not break local loopback access.

---

7. AI model problems

Newsroom runs models through a local Ollama service. The installer does not bundle Ollama or model weights.

Local AI runtime unavailable

Possible cause: Ollama is not installed, is not running, or is listening on a different address.

Safe steps:

1. Confirm Ollama is installed and running on this PC. Newsroom will not start an Ollama service it does not own.
2. In Newsroom, open **Connections** or **Diagnostics** and read the **Local model** result.
3. Reopen **AI Models** after the service is available. The page should no longer show the red runtime notice.
4. If your organisation blocks local services, ask the administrator before changing firewall settings.

A model download fails or stops

Possible cause: no internet, a registry rate limit, insufficient disk space, or the local Ollama service stopped.

Safe steps:

1. Check free disk space. The three profiles need roughly 2.68 GB, 3.32 GB or 6.55 GB for the model itself, plus temporary space.
2. Confirm the connection is stable and retry from **AI Models**.
3. If a transfer is running, use **Cancel transfer** before retrying; do not start a second download for the same profile.
4. If the page reports a digest mismatch, do not force the model into use. Remove and re-download the profile through **AI Models** when the service is healthy.
5. A failed download never changes an existing published edition.

The model is installed but drafting refuses to start

Possible cause: the selected model has not passed the local test for its exact installed digest.

Safe steps:

1. Open **AI Models**.
2. Confirm the profile shows as installed and selected.
3. Choose **Test local model** and wait for the result.
4. If the test fails, read the message. A memory failure needs a smaller profile or more available memory; a schema failure may need a retry; a timeout may need a shorter issue.
5. Do not switch a real channel to “fixture” drafting to bypass the test. Fixture drafting is reserved for the demonstration channel.

Out of memory, very slow drafts, or the machine becomes unresponsive

Possible cause: the model is larger than the available GPU or system memory, or a model and a large layout are running together.

Safe steps:

1. Use **Standard** or **Compact** rather than **Enhanced** on a 6 GB GPU or a 16 GB laptop.
2. Close other memory-heavy applications before a build.
3. Wait for the current build to finish before starting another.
4. Do not run a 150-post layout and a local model at the same time on a memory-constrained machine.
5. If the machine is unresponsive, wait for the checkpoint; if you must restart, recover the job from **Jobs** afterwards.

AI output is poor or contains unsupported statements

This is an editorial issue, not a reason to trust the output more. Newsroom runs an independent evidence audit, but the audit cannot prove that a sentence is true. Read **Source evidence**, **Claims** and the **Audit** panel. Edit or hold the article. A model result is never a substitute for editorial verification.

---

8. Jobs, queue and build problems

A build stays **Scheduled** or **Queued**

Possible cause: the background worker did not start, is already busy, or the machine blocked the worker process.

Safe steps:

1. Open **Jobs** and the job page. Read the stage and progress.
2. Wait a short time. A second build does not make the first one faster.
3. Check **Connections → Local model** if the job is a real-channel build; real-channel drafting requires a tested model.
4. If the job remains queued with no progress, use **Stop safely**, then **Continue from checkpoint**. If the job never started, **Retry failed job** or **Restart from beginning** may be available.
5. Do not create a second job for the same window. Newsroom reuses or refuses a duplicate window by design.

A job seems stuck in a stage

Possible cause: a long model call, a large media download, a slow PDF render, or a stale worker.

Safe steps:

1. Read the progress line and the **Heartbeat** time. A stale heartbeat is different from a slow operation.
2. Wait for the watchdog message. Long operations should report that they are still working.
3. If the heartbeat is stale, use **Stop safely**, then **Continue from checkpoint**.

4. Use **Restart from beginning** only when you accept that the current draft state will be discarded.
5. Use **Cancel job** only when you want to abandon that job permanently; it cannot be undone, though its source checkpoint is retained for a later manual build.

A job failed

Safe steps:

1. Read the error on the job page. The stage name tells you where it stopped: collection, classification, drafting, media, layout or release.
2. If the error mentions a missing rights declaration, fix the rights on the source page; do not retry blindly.
3. If the error mentions media, check whether the source file was deleted or withdrawn. Text can still render without an image.
4. If the error mentions the model, see §7.
5. If the error mentions layout or PDF, see §10.
6. After fixing the cause, use **Retry failed job**. Keep the job number for support.

Awaiting review will not release

This is not a failure. The edition has open review items. Open the edition and read **Release held**. Resolve each item in the article's **Review items** panel, set the article status, then rebuild the preview and release again. A high-risk or unsupported claim always needs an editor.

A build produced **no content**

A verified empty window is not a skip. It means no includable posts were found in that cutoff window. Check the source posts and the window boundaries. A post at exactly the cutoff belongs to the next issue.

The machine restarted during a build

1. Start Newsroom and open **Jobs**.
2. A job interrupted by a restart may be `paused`, `resumable` or `failed_retryable`.
3. Use **Continue from checkpoint** if available, or **Retry failed job** after the cause is understood.
4. Do not create a duplicate build for the same window unless the existing job is terminal and you have read its result.

---

9. Review and release problems

Release version is disabled

Possible cause: one or more blocking review items remain.

Safe steps: open each article in the edition, read **Review items**, choose **Approve item** or **Reject item**, and set the article status. Use **Rebuild preview only** after copy changes. Then return to the edition and try again.

I edited a published edition and now see a new version

This is expected. A published edition is immutable. Saving an article from a published workspace creates a new working version, typically **Open working version N+1**. The published version stays frozen. Review the new draft, then release the new version when it is ready.

The preview does not match the saved text

Possible cause: the preview is stale.

Safe steps: choose **Rebuild preview only** or **Save and Update Preview**. Wait for the preview state to become **current**. Do not release a version whose preview is stale.

A correction needs to be visible to readers

Create a new working version, make the correction, rebuild the preview, and release the new version. Do not edit files in an old edition folder. The old version remains available for the audit trail.

---

10. PDF, preview and layout problems

The PDF renderer is unavailable or the build cannot render

Possible cause: the bundled print browser is missing or cannot start, or the Windows runtime is damaged.

Safe steps:

1. Open **Connections** and check **Print browser** and **Paged.js renderer**.
2. Close and reopen Newsroom.
3. If the runtime or print browser remains unavailable, reinstall the same Newsroom release over the existing installation. Your data folder is separate and should remain.
4. If the problem persists, collect the job's log path and contact support.

The preview PDF is blank, truncated or out of date

1. Choose **Rebuild preview only**.
2. If the pages are blank, inspect the job log and the edition's **Quality inspection** panel.
3. Check that the page size is **Tabloid 11 × 17 in** or **A3** as intended.
4. Do not release an edition with a blank page or an obvious clipping error.

Text is clipped, overlapping or runs off the page

Possible cause: an unusually long headline, an unbroken URL, a long proper name, a wide table, or a theme metric that is too large.

Safe steps:

1. Shorten the headline or move detail into the deck.
2. Break long URLs or names in the copy where that is editorially acceptable.

3. Check the **Quality inspection** result for the failing page.
4. Do not reduce the body font below the allowed minimum just to force a fit.
5. Rebuild the preview and inspect at 100% zoom.

Pages are underfull

Underfull pages are reported, not automatically a proof failure. A sparse page may be a legitimate short issue or a composition problem. Check the article mix, section ordering and page plan. Do not add filler or invented copy to fill space.

The PDF is not 11 × 17 inches

Check **Branding → Paper size**. The tabloid PDF should be 11 × 17 inches (792 × 1224 points). If the geometry is wrong, correct the publication profile and rebuild. Do not release a wrongly sized PDF as a tabloid.

---

11. Images, media cache and fonts

An image is missing from an article

Possible cause: the source media was not imported, was deleted at source, exceeded a size limit, failed its rights check, or was removed from the cache.

Safe steps:

1. Open the article's **Media** section and read the current selection.
2. Open the source post and check whether the media is still present and rights-cleared.
3. Re-import the media or choose another eligible source asset.
4. If the image is not essential, render the article text-only rather than using an unrelated picture.
5. Do not substitute a stock image and present it as source evidence.

The Media cache page says files are protected

That is expected. Files used by a draft, an awaiting-review edition, a failed or running edition, an editor lock, a recent ingestion window or an incomplete published bundle are protected. Use the dry-run information before clearing anything.

The two clear buttons are destructive:

- **Clear unused media cache (safest)** removes only files the page identifies as safe to delete.
- **Clear all deletable media (including derivatives)** also removes derivatives.

Do not use either button while a build is running. If media is needed again, it may have to be downloaded or imported again. Source posts, captions, credits, rights records and audit events remain.

Urdu or another script is in the wrong font

Possible cause: the chosen font family does not contain the required glyphs. Newsroom reports this in **Appearance → Print checks** instead of silently pretending the font supports the script.

Safe steps:

1. Choose a family with the required script coverage, or import a licensed font that has it.
2. Re-render the print proof and inspect the specimen.
3. Do not accept a fallback if the script is central to the page; check the actual PDF, not only the browser preview.

An imported font cannot be deleted

A font used by a saved theme revision is intentionally protected so an archived design remains reproducible. Create a new theme without that font first, then remove it from the library if it is no longer referenced.

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12. Source codes, QR labels and the evidence appendix

No QR code is printed

Possible cause: the publication has no verified public evidence-page base URL, or the source code policy is **No printed codes**.

Safe steps:

1. Open **Branding** and read **Source code policy**.
2. Only set **Public evidence-page base URL** if you actually host the exported source bundles at that address.
3. Tick **I have verified that the public evidence-page base URL serves the exported source bundles** only after checking it.
4. If no public target exists, leave the truthful source appendix mode in place. Do not invent a URL or print a localhost address.

A QR code points to the wrong page

The printed code is only as good as the public evidence base URL and the source record. Test the URL from another device before release. If it is wrong, correct the branding and rebuild; do not edit the published PDF by hand.

The e-paper source appendix is incomplete

Open the edition's **E-paper** and check the **Sources** page. A source may have no public URL; the appendix then shows a message rather than a broken link. That is deliberate. If the underlying source record is missing, check the article's evidence.

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13. Database busy, duplicate data and concurrency

Database temporarily busy. Your change was not saved.

Meaning: another Newsroom process held the single SQLite writer for a moment. The request was not applied.

Safe steps:

1. Wait a few seconds and repeat the action.
2. Check **Jobs** for a long-running collection or build.
3. Do not run two Newsroom windows or two workers against the same data folder.
4. If the message repeats, close Newsroom with **Pause safely and exit**, reopen it, and try once. Do not delete `-wal` or `-shm` files.

Two editions exist for the same window

A manual build with a different window or edition name is a legitimate separate edition. For an unexpected duplicate, record both edition numbers and inspect **Audit** before deleting anything. Do not delete a published edition to “clean up”; published editions are the archive.

The same build is submitted twice

Newsroom should reuse the existing job or tell you that the window was already built. If you see a duplicate, open **Jobs** and identify which job is active. Do not cancel a running job merely because a second submission returned an error.

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14. Schedules and unattended runs

A schedule did not create an edition at the cutoff

Possible cause: the schedule is disabled, the day is not selected, no worker was running at the cutoff, or the edition is waiting for review.

Safe steps:

1. Open **Schedules** and check **Enabled**, the weekdays, **Cutoff**, **Release** and the timezone.
2. Check **Review required** and **Auto-release only clean, non-risk editions**. A held edition does not release itself.
3. Use **Run the latest cutoff now** to test the schedule deliberately.
4. Use **Enqueue missed cutoffs** to catch up missed windows.
5. Remember the installed product does not create a Windows scheduled task. If Newsroom was closed, no worker was running. Automatic unattended runs require a Windows task or another worker setup outside the normal interface; this was not verified for this documentation.

The release time passed but nothing was published

The release timestamp is not an automatic publish command for a held edition. A build that contains high-risk or unsupported claims waits for an editor even when auto-release is configured. Review the edition and release it manually.

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15. Backup, restore and recovery

Make a backup before changing anything

1. Close Newsroom with **Pause safely and exit**. Confirm that the **Newsroom** process is gone in Task Manager.
2. In File Explorer, open `%LOCALAPPDATA%`.
3. Copy the entire `ChannelPress` folder to an external drive or another safe location.
4. Keep the copy's date in its name, for example `ChannelPress-backup-2026-10-31`.
5. If you also want to preserve the exact installed program version, copy `%LOCALAPPDATA%\Programs\Newsroom` separately. The program folder is replaceable; the data folder is not.

The data folder contains the database, media, imported fonts, theme proofs, logs and published output. Treat it as private. It may also contain a Telegram session; never share it or put it in cloud storage you do not control.

Restore a backup

1. Close Newsroom and confirm that no **Newsroom** or **NewsroomWorker** process remains.
2. Rename the current `%LOCALAPPDATA%\ChannelPress` folder to `ChannelPress-before-restore` rather than deleting it.
3. Copy the backup folder into `%LOCALAPPDATA%` and rename it to `ChannelPress` if necessary.
4. Start Newsroom. Check **Dashboard**, **Editions** and a known PDF/e-paper.
5. If the restored database does not match the installed version, keep the original folder and seek help. Do not repeatedly overwrite the data folder.

Restore is a whole-folder operation. Do not merge individual database files from different dates.

A published edition folder was moved or renamed

The edition may no longer appear correctly in Newsroom. Restore the folder to its original path from backup. Do not edit the manifest or checksum files.

I need to recover an interrupted build

Use the job's **Continue from checkpoint** or **Retry failed job** actions before restoring an old database. A restore can lose newer work that is not in the backup.

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16. Collecting information for support

What to include

- Newsroom version (1.0.0 for this release) and the Windows version.
- The exact screen and button label where the problem occurred.
- The job number, stage and error text for a failed build.
- The exact status from **Connections** and **Diagnostics**.
- The last few lines of the relevant log file.
- Whether the problem happens with the fixture channel, an imported channel, or a live Telegram channel.

Where the logs are

Open `%LOCALAPPDATA%\ChannelPress\logs`. Files are named by date, for example `desktop-20261031.log`, `web-20261031.log` and worker logs. A failed job page also shows the log folder path associated with that job.

What never to send

Never send:

- `telegram.session` or any file with `session` in its name;
- `.env` or any file containing API credentials;
- `secret.key`;
- the database file, unless a trusted maintainer explicitly asks for a sanitised copy;
- private article text, source exports, phone numbers, channel member data or personal information.

Before sharing a log, remove Windows usernames, filesystem paths, channel handles, phone numbers and story text. A log may contain local paths even when it contains no credentials.

When to stop and ask for help

Stop and seek help if:

- the database or data folder is missing;
- a restore fails;
- a published edition's files are damaged;
- a Telegram session may have been exposed;
- the application repeatedly fails at startup after a restart;
- you are asked to delete data to "fix" an error that is not explained.

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17. Frequently asked questions

Do I need an internet connection to use Newsroom?
No for local editing, viewing existing editions, and the fixture workflow. Yes for installing WebView2 if it is missing, downloading models, live Telegram access and optional web research.

Does Newsroom upload my articles or sources to a cloud service?
The packaged application is designed to keep data local. AI inference is local through Ollama. Optional research providers, if configured, make external requests. The verified default workflow does not send source content to an online model.

Can I run two copies of Newsroom?
No. It is a single-window, single-instance application so that the database and Telegram session are not used by two processes at once.

Can I use Newsroom without AI?
The fixture demonstration can build without a model. A real channel's drafting requires a local Ollama model that has passed the local test in **AI Models**. There is no built-in cloud AI fallback.

Can I publish automatically to a website or social network?
No. **Release version** freezes a local edition. It does not upload it anywhere.

Can I edit an edition after release?
Not the released version. Open a new working version, make the change, rebuild the preview and release the new version. The old version remains immutable.

Where is the PDF?
Use **Published PDF** on the edition, or open `%LOCALAPPDATA%\ChannelPress\output\<publication>\<edition>\` in File Explorer.

Can I read the e-paper without Newsroom?
Yes. The e-paper bundle is self-contained. Open its `index.html` from the edition folder. The in-app **E-paper** button opens the same bundle.

Does a schedule run while Newsroom is closed?
Not by itself in the installed product. A schedule defines the cutoff and release times and can be run manually. Unattended operation depends on a Windows task or worker setup that the installer does not create.

Why is my edition Awaiting review?
The build completed, but editorial review items remain. Open the edition, resolve the items in each article, rebuild the preview and release it.

Can I delete a published edition?
Do not delete published editions. They are the archive and their checksums and provenance are part of the record. If disk space is a problem, archive the whole edition folder to external storage first.

Is my Telegram session a password?
Yes. Anyone with the session file can act as that account until it is revoked. Keep the data folder private and use **Sign out** when you stop using an account.